Poebel 1914, PBS 4/1 — "A New Creation and Deluge Text" (pp. 9–70) — raw OCR extract

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A NEW CREATION AND DELUGE TEXT

INTRODUCTION

The tablet published as No. 1 of the present volume contains a Sumerian account of the creation, the founding of prediluvian cities and the deluge. I found this tablet in the summer of 1912 in several fragments among the tablets which had been numbered and catalogued by the former curator of the Babylonian section of the Museum, Prof. H. V. Hilprecht.1 According to the catalogue it was dug from the soil of Nippur during the third Babylonian expedition of the University of Pennsylvania.

The tablet, as published here, represents only the lower portion of the original. This measured about 7 inches or 17.8 centimeters in length and 5% inches or 14.3 centimeters in width and its inscribed surface was about three times that of the present fragments. There is, however, some hope that at least some of the missing fragments will be found either in the University Museum at Philadelphia or in the Museum at Constantinople, since the breaks on the upper side of the

recovered portion are very sharp, a fact which seems to indicate that the missing portions were broken off only after the tablet was dug from the soil.

As regards the contents of our tablet, this will best be seen from the transcription and translation of the text itself. A brief synopsis, however, may perhaps be found useful by those who do not care to read the technical remarks in the last section of this chapter, or who are not so thoroughly accustomed

1 The box in which the main fragment of the tablet was preserved is labeled: Inc 10673, Ni. 19-12-04. According to this the tablet was entered in the catalogue o 19, 1904. The catalogue contains the following entry: 10673 | H. V.H.| 19-12-04 fragment of baked clay | III. Exp. | Box 13. In a search for the missing portion tablet, | found two small fragments which proved to belong to the tablet and wer joined on. These had been catalogued, together with a third piece which did not to this tablet, under the number 10562.

to the quaint peculiarities and especially to the abrupt style of ancient poetry—for our text 1s a poem as may be seen from the mere external appearance of the tablet, namely, the arrangement of the lines and the frequent blank spaces between the various groups of signs due to the rhythmical character of the text. Readers of the Bible, moreover, will easily recognize the quaint principle of partial repetition or paraphrase in parallel lines, which is so characteristic a feature of Hebrew poetry.

At the beginning of the preserved portion of the first column we find the goddess Nintu(r) or Nin-harsagga speaking of the destruction of mankind which she calls hers, because she was one of its creators as we shall presently see. It is not clear, however, whether in this passage she promises to

protect human kind from destruction or whether she declares her intention to destroy human kind. In the annotations at the end of this chapter it will be shown how the answer to this question would definitely establish the relation between the first two columns of our tablet and the rest of the text, the point at issue being whether the former represent an independent account of the creation or simply a retrospective description of the origin of what was to perish in the flood, namely, all living beings and the cities which man had built. Unfortunately it will be impossible to give a definite answer to this important question as long as the upper portion of the tablet is missing.

Be this as it may, in |. 11 we read that the creating deity fixes the commandments concerning man, 7. e., defines his duties and his rights, one of which is, e. g., the building of cities and temples in a "'clean spot," 7. e., in hallowed places.

The last lines of the first column refer to the creation of the animals which by this passage are shown to have been created after man just as in the second Biblical account of the creation in Genesis 2. The introductory lines 13 and 14, which form the transition from the account of the creation of man to that of the animals, fortunately give us the names of the four creators of mankind, namely, An, Enlil, Enki and the goddess Nin-harsagga, the four highest deities of the Babylonian

pantheon. It has hitherto been almost completely overlooked what an important part the last named deity played in the earlier Babylonian period, especially in the southern section of the country; our passage, therefore, furnishes us a most welcome clue concerning the position of this deity. One of the sacred cities of this goddess, the city of Adab, has been made known to us by the excavations of the University of Chicago.

In the preserved portion of the second column we read of five prediluvian cities of Babylonia, which were founded and

bestowed upon various deities evidently by the most powerful of the gods, namely, Enlil, the lord of all the lands. As the first of these cities, Eridu, is given to Enki, the lord of the ocean, who is the third of the gods in rank, it is evident that the now missing upper portion reported the founding of the sacred cities of the two highest gods, namely, Uruk, the city of An, god of Heaven, and Nippur, the city of Enlil himself, which has been partially excavated by the University of Pennsylvania, and where our own tablet was dug from the soil. In one of the two cities, moreover, one of the created men must have been established as the first king of Babylonia, but in our text we have preserved only an allusion to the creation of the insignia of this king in the broken lines at the beginning of Column 2.

The last lines of the column are not clear to me; possibly they treat of the creation of canals, etc., the water of which was indispensable for the existence of the Babylonian cities: for without it the land would turn into a sandy desert as indeed it has in many places at the present day.

In the third column of our fragment we are already in the story of the flood. The gods have resolved to destroy mankind, but when it comes to the execution of the decision, the gods, and especially the goddesses Innanna and Nintu, are filled with terror and the latter with repentance for the great calamity which they have caused. But it is only Enki, the god of wisdom, who is able to devise a plan to save at least one of the doomed race, Ziugzddu, the tenth and last of the prediluvian kings, who like Noah in the Bible was a pious man; in Column 4 we there-

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fore read that Enki informs Ziugiddu of the resolution of the gods, and the missing part of the same column must have reported how Ziugiddu built his boat and placed in it his family

and all kinds of artisans as well as all sorts of animals.

In the fifth column the deluge itself is recounted. In accordance with the older Biblical account it is caused only by a strong rain or, in the Babylonian expression, the rain demon, not as in the later Biblical account also by the waters from underneath the earth. The duration of the rain is seven days and seven nights; in this our tablet differs from the previously known Babylonian account which gives it as six days only; nevertheless, in this point our text stands much nearer to this other Babylonian account than to either Biblical tradition, the older of which makes the rain last forty days and nights, while according to the later tradition the flood continued to rise for five months. :

After the rain has ceased, the sun-god appears from behind the clouds and is the first to observe Ziugzddu in his boat which is floating on the waters. Our hero prostrates himself before the god and by offering up sacrifices evidently wins his favor. In the sixth and last column, after an obscure passage, he prostrates himself before Enlil who had been chiefly responsible for the resolution of the gods to destroy mankind. But he too is now appeased and shows his favor by making Ziugzddu a god. In the last of the preserved lines the gods take Ziugzddu to a distant land, probably the country of Dilmun somewhere on the shore of the Persian gulf, where he lives thenceforth as a god. |

A. POEBEL—CREATION AND DELUGE TEXT 1

TRANSCRIPTION
COLUMN 1

The upper part of the column, about three-fourths of the text, is missing.

bee 3 a ee LVS iia eae ee ea eiti rs: Tp atte ate

nam-lu-qal-mu ha-lam-ma-bi-a_ ga-ba-nfi-..... |
Miin-tu-ramip-dim-dimemia-mulew si-pee, ee. |

ga-ba-ni-1b-gi-gi
5’ uku_ ki-Ur-bi-ta = ga-ba-ni-1b-gur-ru-NE
uru. ki-me-a-bi he-im-mi-in-dut
e1S-gé-bi ni-ga-ba-ab-dtib-bu
é'-me-a_ sig-bi ki-azag-ga he-1m-mi-in-Sub(u)
ki-eS-me-a_ ki-azag-ga_ he-im-mi-ni-ib-r1
10’ azag-a‘-NIG-NE-te(me)-na__ si-mi-ni-in-si-sa
garza-me-mah Su-mi-ni-1b-Su-dt
ki-a-im-ma-ab-KA DJ]-ga.mu-ni-in-ga
an ‘en-lil ‘en-ki “nin-har-sag-ga-ge
sag-gé-ga mu-un-dim-eSs-a-ba
15’ nig-x*-ki-ta ki-ta mu-dib-dib
MAS-ANSU _ nig-dr-limmu?-edin-na
me-te-a-aS _ bi-fb-gal

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ein

COLUMN 2

The upper part of the column, about three-fifths of the text, is missing.

SO). aan Le Sd Ea eee |

ah | eee ees ge ees oT) lee leeks ee eee |
Wietraeake Ler eee RS ee (PER esas Sse ee |
eet ns ee e111 | 1gi-ga-ba-ni-ib-dt-[..... we MTRe > |

[...]..-dim-kalam-ma-ge uS-gi[-...-g]i-..]..-ab-bar-[...]

1 Not quite certain.

2 Perhaps zI + ZI, g1 + gl, etc.

3 Perhaps to be read tab-tab.

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Ree iee a: |. .-nam-lugal-la an-ta-é€-|...-Ja-ba

1o’ [..]..-mah_ gi8-g[u]?-[z]jar nam-lugal-la an-ta-é-a-ba

[garza-me-mJah [..... _. .8}u-mi-ni-1b-Su-dt

[ss eka ike ae J-ga ufrur-.... bjar-an-da-sub

20

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mu-bi ba-an-s[a-a_ ka|b-dt-gla] [b]a-[ha]l-[hal]l-la

uru-bi-e-ne eridu“ md%-sag “nu-dim-mut

mi-ni-in-si

a-kam-ma TU! nu-gi-ra bad-NAGAR+DIS™ mi-ni-in-si

3-kam-ma_ la-ra-ak “pa-bil-har-sag_ mi-ni-in-si

4-kam-ma zimbir® Sul “utu mi-ni-in-si

s-kam-ma Surubba(k)" °SU-KUR-RU-ra_ mi-ni-in-si

uru-bi-e-ne mu-bi_ ba-an-sa-a

kab-du-ga_ ba-hal-hal-la |

a-ef- DAR. ma.an(?)-SU(?)? A-AN*. im-ma-al-la.a-im-ma-an-

DU

i-tur-tur-ri Su-luh. BI-GAR. HAR-HAR_ mi-ni-fb-ga-ga

Sion aly ies ate VEE LO eee

COLUMN 3

The beginning of the column, about two-thirds of the text, is missing.

10’ ki- ATl=fia Grivd| cele eee eee ee |
TE] es as, ak co eee |
SETT=TU Wepeeeae eee, ee |
ae eA oi ara ea ee ane oe 2 |
ce PeNENE? aI (S) a [ses 2 ei eet eee |
(5! iicbi-a. eatlin=t| Ua es eae (dimiy:a| ee ee |
azag“innanna-ge uku-bi-Si a-nir, mu-[..... |
fen-ki “Sa-ni-te-na-pe. aqi-ni-v) se Pde
an .en-lila sen-Kiy omin-har-sao-04-0| cane eer
dingit-an-ki-ge* mu-an-'en-lili’ mau-nii-. 0 9s ee |
20' "0-ba: ~z1-0-GLD-diy Slugal-amieirpas75"| 2 ee |

1 Perhaps intended for 2-kam-ma-Su?

2 Seems to be the sign REC 308.

3 Perhaps a§-ti(?)?

4 Perhaps har-dim bi-in-(§)4 .... “thus they (he) ....”

5

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A. POEBEL——CREATION AND DELUGE TEXT |e

AN-SAG-giir-gtir mu-un-dim-dim en[.....
nam-BUR-na_ KA-si-si-gi ni-te-g4[.....
d-Sti-uS-e SAGSUS-OU= Wel amine nee a eat |
ma-mu-nu-me-a é-dé KA-bal[..... |
mu-an-ki-bi-ta pa-pa-dé[.....

COLUMN 4

[..].-...-80' dingir-ri-e-ne GIS-SI[G?.....:..

zi-0-G|[D-du-da-bi(?).gub-ba_ giS-mu-..[.....
iz-zi-da_ 4-gtib-bu-mu_ gub-ba[.....
iz-zi-da i(nim)-ga-ra-ab-di-di [.....
na-ri-ga-mu_gi8-TU-P[I..... Leer
Sur-me-a a-ma-ru z-du? kab-d[i-ga..... |

numun-nam-lu-qal ha-lam-e-d[é.....
di-til-la | i(nim)-bu-dh-ru-[um-dingir-ri-e-ne-ka..... .
Ue te Omer Te eT [lit vos ce a
foiatuoucale bie bal-bi- «0! |. same cote." |

Sie (Coat Mewes (ate 4, aaa

The rest of the column, about three-fourths of the text, is missing.

COLUMN 5

im-hul-im-hul-ni-gtr-gtir-gal_dii-a-bi_ ur-bi _ni-lah-gi-e§
a-ma-ru. u-du* kab-dt-ga__ba-an-da-ab-tr-tr

a-7-4m gé-7-Am

a-ma-ru. kalam-ma_ ba-ur-ra-ta

“”ma-gtir-gtir a-gal-la im-hul-bul-bul-a-ta

! Perhaps ki-ur-Sur
2 Probably engar = igarum “‘wall.”
’ Perhaps U+ KA(=ugu or muh).
4See note to 4p.

16

1O

1O

UNIVERSITY MUSEUM—BABYLONIAN SECTION

zi-t-GID-du “‘md-gtir-gtir KA(?)-BUR mu-un-da-BUR
Sul-‘utu giS-Sir-ni? . $a?- “*ma-gtir-gtir-St —_ ba-an-tii-ri-en
zi-d-GID-du_ lugal-am

igi-‘utu-8 KK A-ki-su-ub-ba-tum

lugal-e gi im-ma-ab-gaz-e ul[dju im-ma-ab-Sar-ri
eae [enevis 1202s eesti aes |... .-la-da-

Raat ee ede |... tab-ba

The rest of the column is missing.

COLUMN 6

zi-an-na_ zi-ki-a__ni-pa-dé-en-ze-en
za-zu-da_ he-1m-da-la
an-en-lil zi-an-na_ zi-ki-a ni-pa-dé(-en)-ze-en
_za-da-ne-ne_ im-da-la
nig-x(-ma)'ki-ta? é-dé im-ma-ra-é-dé
zi-Q-GID-du_lugal-am
igi-an-“en-lil-l4-SX. =.KA-ki-su-ub-ba-tiim
ti dingit-dim mu-un-na-si-mu 7

zi-da-rf dingir-dim mu-un-na-ab-é-dé
ti-ba zi-G-GID-du_lugal-am
mu nig-x-ma numun-nam-li-qal-URU?-a
kur-bal kur-dilmun?r-na - ki-.......... -SQ = mu-un-ti-es
ARAN ip ce Ls ig Be Reicks! Ska: Were bel Pau Lk gal-rbir tir-eS-ar

The rest of the column, about three-fourths of the text, 1s missing.

LEFT EDGE

1 Frasedr
2 Written over an erased da?

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TRANSLATION

COLUMN 1

Se ae ee an erin e) ‘e,4tht 36! el Ke) (ah o) 6) SF os) aes See ere ee erre” Mt

BiVinvee iN (ll Sw CT Cati0 UL Seeaie is ei ondon te, Yee ot
[ee willP Clete tis Wade ie a ees oO
“The people in their settlements | will (let us)......
PCT TICS 7 Sates ane yin bah he may build,
their shade (protection) I will (let us)......
“The brick of our houses may he cast in a clean spot,
bole) {iter ic places may he establish in a clean spot.”’

OUI eee eee ee of the temennu she made: straight
for it, }
The sublime commandments and precepts she made perfect
for it,
After An, Enlil, Enki and Nin-harsagga
Had created the blackheaded,
Whi a eee laa Wale w eager ef TPMMOL Shen eTL L717) cdl ec Wanner a

15’ The animals, the four legged, of the field artfully they wales

10’

into existence.

COLUMN 2
Pi Re een te Tewille(leti us iieenmee sae tice ae upon him
us yee ee AO Tate I will (let us) look upon hzm.”’
After the maker ofthe . 4... of the land, the establisher
Gieraeet@UnCa OMsrOlet Games an:
Hladcerenicdet lice. ween cele of royalty,
Created the sublime ..... ethesye. Fhe of royalty,

The sublime commandments and precepts he made perfect
for it.

71

chs

20’ At that time Ziugzddu was king, the paSiSu of

UNIVERSITY MUSEUM—BABYLONIAN SECTION

In clean places five cities he founded,

(And) after their names he had called, (and) they had
been allotted to kabdu(ga)s

= Hex seen of these cities, Eridu, to the leader Nudimmut
he gave,

Secondly atosc ae ee Bad-NAGAR+DIS he gave,

Thirdly, Larak to Pabilharsag he gave,

Fourthly, Sippar to the hero Sama& he gave,

FifthlySuruppakitow see nee he gave—;

After the names of these cities he had called, (and) to
kabdu(ga)s they had been allotted,

Nene eee Cee Jo ho Gn ie aeee het '

eae small'rivers.and Suluhs ...02")). hevestablished a=

Bi Fah am 6 a! Teh eu e500 Leura lel te 62) ver ue eh we ie) ep eae

(iheemans < place 2154.4 eee ee

IDE DEO plea a

STAINS TOE tLe eae

A Nel iAee ee. they mades eee

At that time Nintu screamed like a woman 1n travail

The holy [Star wailed on account of her people.

Enki in his own heart held counsel.

Anu, Enlil; Enkiand Nin-harsaccas se, eee

The gods of Heaven and Earth invoked the name of Anu
(and) Enlil.

PANG NLOR SLs) ra call lend, heimadey a2)... 7e cer eee

In humility prostrating himself, in reverence

Daily and perseveringly standing in attendance .....,

Bee hs. ing by dreams which had not been (before), ...

25° Conjurzng by the name of Heaven and Earth .....

A. POEBEL—CREATION AND DELUGE TEXT 19
COLUMN 4

OLMee tere es. Mote Yexerels brs Veo ee ne
Ziugiddu standing at its(?) side heard .....
“At the wall at my left side stand and .....,
‘At the wall I will speak a word to thee.
“O my holy one, thy ear open to me
Bis eOUISVONAUL)-abralnistoriniue, as ene pee
will be sent;

melordestroy, the:seed ‘or mankimnds tows, . tia
“Is the decision, the saying of the assembly of ite gods,
* bhe-commands of Anuitand) Enlil) /....+....5...,
Blisetiietakinvdonveliss tein) Tuless «4... 6. ,
UGH Nan e d Denes eee

COLUMN 5

All the windstorms which possess immense power, they
all (and) together came,

eat SCOUIN wna en ee i eis, ak raged with them.

When for seven days, for seven nights

The rainstorm in the land had raged,

The huge boat on the great waters by the windstorms had
been carried away,

Sama’ came forth (again), shedding light over Heaven and
Earth.

AMC TAO sO Desiad aes a at: ha 8 os i 3 of the huge boat,

The light of the hero Sama§ he lets (thou lettest) enter into
the interior? of the huge boat.

Ziugiddu, the king,

Before Sama§ he prostrates himself,

The king, an ox he sacrifices, a sheep he slaughters.

W hile eee SLOT UUOT lease eieaae NaN te.)

er] RRO re ere ee Reis Onanini

5

Wrst Sar tj e OE Ree peek oy, Chane Ole ke) 0 Sin Chel Oe nee ne ee wk Seed

S 0) fee te Se we, tre Fe eee SP (ORs

UNIVERSITY MUSEUM—BABYLONIAN SECTION

he filled

wie wt BS, 6, Pree) Pee) Kee eee ell Lem es) BE Le Le Sere ee

COLUMN 6

“By the soul of Heayen, by the soul of the earth, ye shall

conjure him,
thatihe ria yes eee ee with you.
“Anu (and) Enlil by the soul of Heaven and by the soul of
the earth ye shall conjure,
ATIC 1 C07 Lee eae with you.’
heats: eae of the ground (with the earth), rising it rises.
Ziugiddu, the king,
Before Anu (and) Enlil he prostrates himself.
Life like (that of) a god he gives (J give ?) to him,
An eternal soul like (that of) a god he creates for him.
At that time Ziugzddu, the king,

Theaname. ot; the) seer “Preserver of the seed of man-
kinds aaa
Crna eae mountain, the mountain of Dilmun .....
they caused him to dwell
A he Tene agen ss ig, Oe A ae they had caused him to dwell,
LEFT EDGE’

uh otra leet ee We 7iptdd ia ee

Mt OE BEIF—-CREATION AND DELUGE -TEXT A

COMMENTARY

COLUMN |

The preserved portion of the first column begins with the direct speech of a deity referring to what man shall do and what the deity or all the gods intend to do with regard to man whose creation must have been reported in the now missing portion of the first column. The beginning of the speech, as well as the lines which stated who the speaker is, are not preserved, but as the expression nam-li-qal-mu, “my humankind,’’ 1. 2, could be used only by a deity who had some special relation to mankind, and as in the following line the possessive pronoun of the first person is anticipated by the genitive “nin-ti-ra, “of Nin-tu(r),” it seems that the words in Il. 1’-o’ are uttered by Nin-tu, the goddess, who is usually known as Nin-harsag(ga), Ninmah or Belit-ill, who according to I. 12 is one of the creators of mankind and evidently its chief creator. Note, moreover, that in the passage Gilg. Ep. XI. 13 the almost identical term niséa, “‘my people,” is used by her, and also compare the annotations to 2).

On the other hand, it would seem that the highest of the gods, Anu‘or Enlil, or the Anu Enlil, would be likely to be credited with determining the duties and rights of man; in this case “nin-tii-ra might easily be taken as a dative dependent on ga-ba-ni-ib-gi-gi, but the expressions ‘“‘“my human kind” and “‘my works” would present some difficulty if they have to be referred to Anu or Enlil; and as we shall see that Nin-harsag herself was, in the oldest period, one of the supreme ruler-deities, it should not surprise us that we find her here in the réle of Anu or Enlil.

For the allusion to the destruction of mankind in nam-lu-qal-mu ha-lam-ma-bi-a, |. 2, I cannot give a satisfactory explanation at the present. As the roots of the verbal forms in Il. 2 and 3 are broken off, and as the meaning of the verbs

in the immediately following lines is not sufficiently clear, we cannot even say whether Nintu according to this passage wishes to have the human race destroyed or whether she promises to guard it against destruction. In the former case we should have to assume a situation such as is presupposed in the lamentation of Belit-ili because of her participation in the plan to destroy the human race, Gilg. Ep. XIi20124; we should then have here already a reference to the cause of the deluge which forms the theme of the last four columns of our tablet; but as in this case the lower part of Column 1 and practically the whole of Column 2 would have to be taken as a kind of retrospective sketch inserted into the main stream of the narrative, the second possibility, namely, that Nintu promises to guard her creation against possible extinction, seems to me by far preferable. A definite solution, however, will be possible only through the recovery of the parts now missing.

On the supposition that Il. 2, 3 and 4 are parallel lines, they may perhaps be reconstructed as follows:

nam-lu-qal-mu ha-lam-ma-bi-a_ga-ba-n[i-ib-gi-gi]
4nin-ti-ra nig-dim-dim-ma-mu _ si-[. . .-bi-a]
ga-ba-ni-ib-gi-g1.

The last verbal form as well as the forms ga-ba-n1-1b-gur-ru-dér, |. 5', and ni-ga-ba-ab-dtib-bu, |. 7, seem to belong to the middle theme ga-bab-dim, 'let me make for myself,' which, however, in the idiom of our text appears with a final e (gab-

gurrud-e, ni-gab-dubb-u)!. | Ha-lam-ma-bi-a_ ga-ba-ni-ib-gi-gi
therefore might perhaps be translated, “I shall cause them to
Deas nee ed from their destruction.”’

Ki-ur, 1. 5’, is in Semitic durusSu, which according to
5 R 41, is a synonym of alu, “city,” and according to 2 R 3545
a synonym of iSdu, “foundation.”

The meaning of ga-ba-ni-ib-gur-ru-dé is very doubtful.
Note that gur(rud) as well as gf-gi have the meaning of ‘“‘to

1 See U.M.B.S., Vol. VI, Grammatical Texts.

turn.” In case the passage should refer to the destruction of
mankind, a translation, ‘““The land in its foundations let us over-
throw,’ would be possible; otherwise the meaning of the passage
must be something like: ‘The people in their settlements let
TESPGE USER EO sas dc! a (for us).”’

Uru-ki-me-a-bi, 1. 6, presents great difficulties; note that
we have here me-a-bi, while the following lines have only
me-a. Possibly me-a-bi is a contraction of two variants me-a,
“our, and bi, “their;” in this case URU. KI might have to
be taken as uru” : uru“-bi he-im-mi-in-di, ‘“‘his cities may he
build.” However, the meaning “our” for me-a is by no means
certain, and ki-me-a-bi may be a formation analogous to a-na-me-
a-bi, “‘whosoever,” and mean “‘wherever (he has built a city).”
Cf. also Gudea, Cyl. A 14, uru-me-a NIG-UL PA-nam-é, etc.

The subject of the singular he-im-mi-in-di is ‘“‘man’’ in
a collective sense.

Ni-ga-ba-ab-dtb-bu perhaps = “I will (or let us) cause
them to rest in it (or upon it, upon them). Cf. nf-d&b(-dtb)

= pasahu, “to rest,” nahu, “to rest,’ but also kuppuru?,

kubburu, etc. = destroy?

Is ki-eS, Il. 9, perhaps a different writing for kéS“, the sanctuary of Belit-ilir

With |. 10 the direct speech, in which the deity explains her intention with regard to mankind seems to be at an end, the following lines probably relating in the third person that this deity establishes the laws by which her intentions are definitively carried into effect. Compare also the similar relation between the direct speech in Column 2,, and the phrase -garza-me-mah su-mi-ni-ib-Su-di in |. 11. For another possi-bility, however, see immediately below.

The meaning of |. 12 1s entirely obscure to me; the verbs seem to be immab-dt and munin-ga, so that ki-a and DI?-ga would probably be objects or designations of the place where the actions take place. But a verbal form ga-mu-ni-in-gi, Cl aval leet wee ee, eee seek im it,’’ would not be impossible, in which case naturally Il. 10-12 would be part of the direct speech and

the subject of the verbs in Il. 10, 11 and 12a would therefore be “man,” not the deity, Il. 10 and 11 then forming simply an amplification of ll. 8 and o.

In the last lines of the first column, Il. 13-17, the narrative, after a recapitulation of the creation of mankind, turns to the creation of the animals. This recapitulation, short as it 1s, is of the greatest value for us, because it gives us the names of the creators of mankind, namely, An, Enlil, Enki and Nin-har-

Sagga.

THE Goppess NIN-HARSAG

Among these four deities, the goddess Nin-harsagga, “‘Lady - of the mountains,” claims. our special interest, because our tablet furnishes the first unequivocal evidence of her participation in the work of creation. The list An | “a-nu-um gives as her most common Semitic name belit-ili, ““Lady of the gods,” of which “nin-dingir-e-ne, one of her Sumerian names, is the exact equivalent. From the inscriptions, however, she is best known, aside from the name Nin-harsagga, as “mah, “‘the great one,” “‘nin-mah, ‘‘the sublime lady,” and “nin-tu_ or “nin-tu, the. former of which means “‘Lady of child-bearing,’ while the latter has no clear etymology.

The name “Lady of the gods’’ clearly indicates that Nin-harsag was one of the deities who held the highest rank among the great gods, and this is fully borne out by the fact that in the inscriptions she is associated with An, Enlil and Enki, the oldest and most important ruler gods, and not with Sin, Sama&, IStar, Adad, etc., the younger of the great gods. It will be observed that in our text she is mentioned after An, Enlil and Enki, which shows that at the time when the tablet was written she followed in rank these three gods. Exactly the same order is found in the kudurru inscriptions of the thirteenth and twelfth centuries B. C., as will be seen from the

following list of the gods mentioned in the imprecations at the ends of these inscriptions.!

Susa, reign of Meli-Sipak (Dél. en Perse II, pl. 21-27) :

Anu, Enlil, Ea and Nin-harsagga (=ilf"rabiati"), Marduk, Sin, NinIB, Gula.

Susa, reign of Marduk-apla-iddina (Dél. en Perse VI, pl. 9, 10) : Anu, Enlil, Ea, Nin-harsag, Sin and Ningal, Samas and A"a, etc. (follow 37 other gods).

London 105, PA-SE dynasty (3R 41): Anu, Enlil, Ea, Ninmah (= ilf"rabiati"), Sin, Samag, Star, Marduk, etc.

Caillou de Michaux, PA-SE dynasty (1R 70) : Anu, Enlil, Ea and Ninmah (=ilf"rabati"), Marduk, Sama8, Sin, etc.

Compare also the same order in the passage Surpu IV: 4 (= in the fourth place) lip-tu-ru "a-nu-um "en-lil "é-a u "nin-mah.

Many of the kudurru inscriptions, however, do not mention Nin-mah at all, which indicates that in the thirteenth and twelfth centuries B. C., despite the fact that Nin-harsagga was one of the highest of the great deities, the cult of the goddess did not have the same importance which it must have had at some earlier period. Note also that in the knob inscription of the Cassite king, UlaburariaS, of the Country of the Sea,' she is even relegated to the fifth place, the gods being enumerated in the order an-nu "AB(or nab?= Enlil) "S4r-Sar (=Ea), "marduk, "nin-mah; here we notice evidently the influence of the theology of Babylon, according to which Marduk is the ruler-god xar' é€oyynv and therefore is placed before Nin-mah. It may perhaps be mentioned here that the former deity seems to have played a much more important role during the earlier Cassite period than during the kingdom of KarduniaS and the second dynasty of Isin, if we may judge from the fact that King Agum rebuilt the temple of Marduk at Babylon, in all its former splendor. During the kingdom

1 See Hinke, BE Ser. D IV,, pp. 231-240.
* Weissbach, Bab. Misc., No. 3.

of Kardunias, however, the Enlil worship, as far as our present material allows us to draw conclusions, again gains the ascendancy over all other cults, probably because the kingdom of Karduniax' had its center in southern Babylonia.' As we shall see below, this was probably likewise responsible for the increasing importance of the cult of Nin-harsag at that time.

In a much earlier period, at the time of Eannadu (at the beginning of the fourth millennium B. C.) and Gudea (at the beginning of the third millennium), however, Nin-harsag held an even higher station than in the kudurru inscriptions of the Cassite time, inasmuch as she then ranked immediately after An and Enlil, preceding the god Enki. Cf., e.g.,

Eannadu, Stele of Vultures : (An either mentioned in the preceding column or not mentioned at all); En-hl 16-1729; Nin-harsag- 17-1807 En=kKis 183710) eeoll0— 1 ldc Udy Utu Rev. 1-2; Nin-ki 3-54).

Gudea, Statue B, in the curses: 8 “an-e “en-lil-e *nin-har-sag-ge, “en-ki..... ges ““cink mee dé, 4“nin-gir-su. .. .ge, etc. (follow eleven other gods).

Gudea, Cyl. B.: 12 *an-azag-gi zi-dé-Su mu-ga_ 13? ‘en-lil-e sag-ba gur-bi-dar ““nin-har-sag-ge igi-zi ba-Si-bar *“en-ki lugal-eridu''-ge temen-bi mu-si ‘en-zi-Sa-....-....-ga-ge *“sin-e me-bi an-ki-a im-mi-diri-ga-am, etc.

Ibidem: 19 an zag-gal-la mu-na-KU "an-ra “en-lil im-ma-ni-uS *“en-lil-ra 2“nin-mah mu-ni-uS (the following lines are missing).

_ The same sequence of the gods as in these early Sumerian inscriptions is also presupposed in the list of gods An | “a-nu-um, as may be seen from its arrangement:

Tablet I. An and his circle.
Enlil and his circle.
Tablet II. Mah (Belit-ili) and her circle.

‘ Note also that the names of the Cassite kings, KadaSman-Enlil, Kudur-Enlil, ar
pounded with Enlil.

A. POEBEL—-CREATION AND DELUGE TEXT oa

Tablet III. Nanna and his circle.
Utu and his circle.
Tablet IV. Innanna and her circle.
Tablet V. NinIB and his circle.
Tablet VI. Nergal and his circle.

This fact proves, of course, that the origin of the list An | eae
nu-um goes back to a very early time.

The inscriptions with which we have thus far dealt, and which attribute so great an importance to Nin-harsag, are all of South-Babylonian origin. An examination of inscriptions from Northern Babylonia, however, shows that there the Lady of the gods did not at any time play an important part. In Naram-Sin’s inscription in the fourth column of the reverse of No. 36, e. g., she is not mentioned at all among the “‘great gods’'' who are enumerated in the order: Innanna-Annunitum, Anu, Enlil, Zamama, Sin, Samas, Nergal, Umes and Ninkar(a). It will be observed that the goddess [Star has here taken the place of the supreme ruler-deity and that as such she is placed even above Anu and Enlil. On the other hand, the inscription also omits Enki who was likewise a deity primarily of the South.

As Nin-harsag, however, the goddess is mentioned in the imprecations at the end of the so-called cruciform monument in Column 1226.99, which proves that she was worshipped _ in Northern Babylonia during the Sargonic period: but the contents of the curse, namely, that she may cut off the bringing forth of children in the land, shows that she was worshipped there only as goddess of birth, not as a ruler-deity. In the imprecations at the end of his code of laws, Hammurabi enumerates the following great deities*: Anu, Rev. 26,;, Enlil 2653 (Ninlil and Enlil 26,,), Enki 263, Sama& 2744, Sin 274, [$kur 2764, Zamama 27s, Innanna 27, Nergal 28.4, Nintu 28, and Ninkarrak 2859. Here Nin-harsag is mentioned under her name “nin-tu, but she plays a very subordinate part, Inasmuch as

1 LI. 15-17, i-lu ra-bi-d-tum.
2 Column 12 264nin-har-sag-ga 7in ma-ti-su *8a-la-da-am ™li-ip-ru-us.
* Reverse, Column 287 il rabdtum (=DINGIR-GAL-GAL) a Sa-me-e t ir-si-tim.

she is mentioned as the tenth among eleven deities and again only in her character as goddess of birth.

From the examination of the inscriptions it 1s evident that Nin-harsag, at least in her character as ruler-deity, was a specifically South-Babylonian deity, an observation which, moreover, is entirely corroborated by the fact that her principal sanctuaries Ke’ and Adab! were both situated in Southern Babylonia; it even seems that for this reason, at least during the oldest periods when the Sumerians were in full possession

1 For KeS see, e. g., Eannadu, Stele of Vultures, Obv. 18 sn in-har-sag-ra Kesey

[esi ...];7 Rim-Sin, date. (Strassm: 11 and 12)3, mu dri-im-“sin lugal nin-mah-e temen-an-ki-bi-da-ta nam-lugal-kalam-kiS?-gal-la-80 ba-an- .... -la, etc.; the l

d

a-nu-um mentions as belonging to Ninharsag’s circle the god 4c4-kisal-nun-na nim “prefect of Ke3” and “lugal-igi-ug nimgir adab™' [....] ‘prefect of Adab.”

For Adab see, beside the last quoted passage, the inscription of Lugal-anna-mund Adab (No. 75 and BE VI, Part 2, No. 130) which mentions our goddess as dnin-ti i dmah in |. 26, and, furthermore, the inscriptions excavated by Banks at Bismya, Mesilim, Banks, Bismya, p. 266:

1. me-silim Mesilim

2. lugal kiS king of Kis,
3. dumu-ki-ag beloved son
4. Inin-har-sag [...] of Ninharsag.

4 a ae fics EELY) | Ue ee ee

5.
(Rest is missing.)

Brick inscription of Dungi, zbid., p. 134:

1. “nin-har-sag For Nin-harsag,

2. nin-a-ni his lady,

3. dun-gi Dung,

4. nita-kal-ga the strong hero,

5. lugal-urf<!-ma king of Ur,

6. lugal ki-en-gi ki-uri-ge king of Sumer and Akkad

7. Sk es-84 her beloved

8. ki-ag-ni KeSSa

9g. mu-na-di he built for her.

(This inscription, by the way, proves that the stone tablet of Ur-engar, OBI, No
came from Bismya; the last lines of this inscription have to be supplemented and

ké8(a)*! her beloved
[k]i-ag-ga-ni KeS(a)
[mJu-na-dii he built for her.

Note the variants ®keS-34 and kés(a)*: keS(S)a evidently denotes the sacred dist
Nin-harsag which was named for her sacred city Ke.

Copper tablet of E-igi-nim-PA-é, ibid., p. 200, I. 1, and No. 311 (of this publi
which is identical with the first-mentioned inscription.

of Southern Babylonia, the idea of domination over Southern Babylonia was associated with Nin-harsag. In this connection it may also be remembered that when Rim-Sin, in the earlier part of Samsuiluna's reign, caused a revolt of Southern Babylonia against the rule of the Akkadians, the goddess Nin-mah, as he tells us in a date formula, raised him to the kingship over the totality(?) of the land! in her temple Ke§S(a).

The fact that Nin-harsag is associated with the highest of the supreme gods is due entirely to her character as a ruler-deity; for the possession of royal power places the divine ruler over the other gods in the same way as it raises a human king above even the most powerful of his subjects. This also is the simple reason why in the earliest inscriptions she ranks above

the god Enki, who was primarily a god of wisdom, etc., and not a god of lordship, a trait which appertains only to Anu and Enlil, and, as we see from the inscriptions above quoted, to Nin-harsag. There is, of course, no doubt that originally Anu, the god of Heaven, the highest of the gods, was worshipped as the sole supreme ruler of the universe. The fact that already in the earliest periods of Babylonian history to which our information goes back, Enlil and Nin-harsag are associated with him as gods of domination, presupposes that in still earlier times these two deities must have played an important part in some significant political event in the Euphrates and Tigris basin. As will be seen from the title rubatum (var. ru-ba-tum) si-Ir-tum Sa ma-ta-tim, "'the sublime lady of the lands," given to Nin-harsag by Hammurabi in his code of laws, the theologians claimed for her the same authority over the countries of the earth as otherwise is exclusively ascribed to Enlil. It is thus evident that the ancient kingdom to whose political predominance the goddess owed her rise to such a supreme position among the gods, must have held sway not only over Babylonia, but over all the surrounding countries. From the human point of view the claim of the goddess to the rule over

1 The meaning of the expression kalam kiS?-gal-la or uku-kiS?-gal-la is not quit

the world takes the form of a bestowal of royal power and its insignia upon the human king; in the quoted date formula of Rim-Sin, Ninmah, therefore, raises the king to kingship, and compare also Code of Hammurabi: 1 *ha-am-mu-ra-bi

3 "be-lum zi-ma-at "ha-at-di-im *Sa u-Sa-ak-h-lu-Su *e-ri-15-tum 2*ma-ma, "Hammu-rabi ..... , the lord, the adornment! of sceptre and tiara wherewith the wise Mama has adorned him." In her character as bestower of the royal diadem Nin-harsag was called "nin-men-na, 'lady of the tiara," in Semitic be-lit me-a-am-mi and be-lit ma-a-mi, from which perhaps her

names “ma-ma and “ma-mi2? have been derived. Of course, she herself likewise wore the diadem as we see from the text 56, Col. 79.4, where the unknown king, the author of the inscription, says that he proceeded to the chamber of Ninmenna and placed a golden tiara upon her head.

Nin-harsag is an entirely independent type of the female deity and has nothing to do either with Ninlil or [Star, with both of whom she is usually identified.2 A clear indication of her independent character may be seen in the fact that she appears as the supreme deity of the cities where she was worshipped, whereas Ninlil, as far as we know, is always only a reflexion of Enlil. Nin-harsag has a husband, the god DUN-PA-é, but he plays a very insignificant réle beside her, about such a role as the wife of a great god plays beside her husband. According to the list of gods An | “a-nu-um (CT 24, 123; 2015) a goddess “belit(or rubat)-i-lit appears as the wife of Anu, and a few lines further on the same deity is equated with Antum and IStar. Whether this Belit-ili is identical with Nin-mah, 1s not certain, but if so, the fact that she is identified with Antum as well as IStar would at least indicate that this goddess cannot originally have been connected with Anu and his circle. It

1 Perhaps simtum has a passive meaning = ‘‘he who is adorned with something.”

2 For these names see in the list of gods An | “a-nu-um, CT 24, 12, 25, the 18th 4ist names of Belit-ili.

3 Thus, e. g., Zimmern in KT?, p. 428-430 (Belit-ili and Nin-mah = IStar) and p. harsag = Ninlil); Jastrow, Religion I, p. 55 (= Ninlil) and p. 252 (= [Star).

4Has the name to be read so?

is, however, much more likely that belit-ili is simply the title which Antum and [Star bore as supreme ruler-deities, though

Antum evidently only as the counterpart of Anum. The orthography of the name is clearly that of the Dynasty of Akkad, and it will be remembered that [Star under Naram-Sin is in fact the highest of the gods, ranking even above An and Enlil. On the other hand, under the name DINGIR-SIG-za-gin-na our goddess Belit-il1 (Mah according to a duplicate), as well as her husband SUL-PA-é-a under the name “maSkim-mi'-lu-har-ra-an-na, plays some part in the circle of Enlil, CT 24, Oig17; although the list does not state what their exact connection with it was, yet from the fact that DINGIR-SIG-zaginna is mentioned together with Ninlil and Suzianna, the wives of Enlil,? it follows that she too was here conceived in the character of a female counterpart of Enlil. Nevertheless, since neither the goddess is expressly designated as the wife of Enlil, nor her husband as Enlil, it is evident that this combination in the list An | “a-nu-um only indicates a general relation between the two ruler-deities, although the mere fact that SIG-zaginna is mentioned together with Ninlil makes it very likely that the equation was based on some special local cult.

Another side of Nin-harsag’s character is that of the mother-goddess. A comparatively frequent appellation of hers is, e. g., ama-dingir-ri-ne, “mother of the gods; cf. Ur-Bau, Statue, 3 “‘nin-har-sag ama-dingir-ri-ne-ra é-gir-su“-ka-ni 2mu-na-di: Lu-Utu, clay nail, 1 ““nin-har-sag %ama-dingir-ri-ne-ra, etc. Gudea, Statue A, 3 ‘nin an-ki-a nam-tar-ri-dé “nin-tu 2ama dingir-ri-ne-ge, etc., “the lady who determines the fate in Heaven and upon earth, Nintu, the mother of the gods,” etc.’ It will

eDeeenOLeran ON Du a.

2 The order is:

1. Ninlil (7 names) | dam-bi sal.
2. Suzianna | dam-banda “enlillage, etc. Enzikalamma | 4dam-bi “enlilli!
3. DINGIR-SIG-zaginna | “be-lit--lf, MaSkim-mi-ld-harranna | 9SUL-PA-é-a.

Suzianna, to mention this by the way, is of course not identical with Ninlil, as stated, but another wife (dam-banda) of Enlil.

* Beginning of the name of a statue which Gudea set up in the temple of Nin-hars

be observed that ama-dingir-ri-ne is an exact parallel to the appellation ab-ba-dingir-ri-ne, ‘father of the gods,” which is given to the ruler-god Enlil; cf., e. g., Entemena, Cone, 1 ‘“en-lil lugal-kur-kur-ra *ab-ba dingir-ri-ne-ge. The terms ab-ba-dingir-ri-ne and ama-dingir-ri-ne do not necessarily imply the idea of physical fatherhood or motherhood, but rather have the meaning, leader of the gods or the first of the puhur ilf; nevertheless the origin of the title undoubtedly lay in the idea of physical fatherhood, for there are many indications of the belief among the Babylonians that Anu the god of Heaven or the Heaven itself, and his wife Ki, “the earth,’ were the progenitors of the gods.! From this point of view it would be very tempting to establish a connection between Nin-harsag and Kj, for har-sag, “mountain,” or in a collective sense ‘“‘mountains,’ might very well be taken as an expression for “‘earth.’”’ Our present material, however, does not afford sufficient evidence for this equation; still it may be kept in mind that Enlil also undoubtedly had originally some relation to the earth, although in the later development of his cult this side of his character has been completely overshadowed by other characteristics.

A clear allusion to physical motherhood, however, is found in two of Nin-harsag’s names in the list An | “a-nu-um, namely, “ama-tu-G-da (var. “ama-i-tu-da), “mother of child-bearing,” and “ama-dii-bad = ummu pi-ta-at bar-ki, var. um-mu pi-ta-a-at bir(!)?-ki, “the mother whose lap (literally knees) is open(ed).”’ Note also that in Gudea, Statue A, the name Nintu, which in the list An | “a-nu-um is written “nin-ti(r) and expressly glossed as (nin-)tu-ur, is written “nin-tu(d), which means “the lady of child-bearing” or the like; unless this’ writing is due to a mistake of the scribe, which is not at all likely, we should have here at least an attempt to refer the name to child-bearing, though the mere existence of the form “nin-ti(r), “nin-ti-ra seems to place it beyond any doubt that the latter is the original

+ A remembrance of the supreme position of An and Kiis still found in the part w

play in the incantations; their names have power even over the highest gods.
* Cf. Meissner, OLZ 109, Cols. 199-201.

name. But in the code of Hammurabi, Rev. 28,9, we have the same writing “nin-tu(d) again and there the relation of the goddess to child-bearing is not liable to any doubt, because Hammurabi gives her the predicate ummum ba-ni-ti, “the mother who has born me,” and wishes that she may deny male offspring to the king who should destroy his inscription, and that she may not “create seed of mankind in the midst of his people.’’ Notwithstanding the obscurity of the etymology of the name Nintu(r), it seems to me, that we have in this side of the character of Nin-harsag an original trait. It may be expected that the full publication of the results of the excavations at Bismya will give us some information on this point, for Banks reports that he found small clay reliefs “‘representing most obscene figures,’ and although he brings them into connection with IStar, who likewise had a temple at Adab, called E-sar or E-sar-ra, they may perhaps be votive objects presented to the goddess of birth. Likewise there is no doubt that the clay figurines which have been found at Nippur and other places, and which represent a goddess suckling a child and clasping one of her breasts, are representations of Nin-harsag and not of Ninlil as 1t 1s mostly assumed,' and the more so, because we know from the inscriptions that the image of Nin-harsag was conceived as that of a mother suckling a child. In the description of images of deities, K 21487, it is expressly said of “nin-tu or “mah: ‘irat-sa pi-ta-a-at ‘ina GUBU-%8a Se-ir-ra na-Sat-ma UBUR-$4 ik-kal ‘ina ZAG-Sa 1-kar-rab, “‘her breast is open (1. e., bare?), in her left she carries a child sucking (?) her (left) breast, with the right she blesses.”’> Cf. also the vase inscription of Lugal-zagegis! in which this king designates himself as 1 *ga-zi-kt-a 2“nin-har-sag, “who was (or is) nourished by the true milk of Nin-harsag.”’ In all likelihood therefore the Mylitta of Herodotus also is the goddess Nin-harsag.

1 As images of Belit-ili (=IStar) reterred to by Zimmern, KAT?, p. 429, note 5.

2 Bezold, ZA LX, p. 121.

3 The clay images represent the goddess as clasping her right breast with her ri
Is this perhaps the gestus of the karabur

A feature of the character of the goddess, widely different, at least at first sight, from those with which we have hitherto dealt, refers to her wisdom and skill in the handicrafts, especially of the carpenter or wood-carver, the potter and the copper-smith. It will be remembered that Hammurabi refers to her

as eristum Mama, “the wise Mama.” Then observe that one of her names in the list An | “a-nu-um is “gurgur-dingir-ri-ne, “coppersmith of the gods,’ another saat He 3 |INAGAR-kalam-

ma, “coppersmith(?) of the land,” “nin-pahar, “lady potter.”? What the proudest works of her hands were, we may again infer from names of hers. She was, e. g., called nagar-nam-lu-gal-lu, “carpenter of mankind;’ “nagar-8a-ga, ‘‘carpenter of the heart; “nig-zi-gdl-dim-dim-me (var. -ma), “builder of what has breath:” °en-MA--SAI-dim, “the maken of. us 5 ae ene 4
We see from these names that Nin-harsag once, no doubt, at the time of creation, exerted her skill in carving men as well as all other living beings in wood, or 1n moulding them in clay, and she too made the most wonderful part of the human body, the heart or the interior of the body.

AN, ENLIL AND ENKI AS CREATORS

The first three of the deities who created mankind according to our text, An, Enlil and Enki, are mentioned as creators, without Nin-harsag, in two short school texts containing the introductory phrases to an incantation or the like. One, which is written in Akkadian, begins with the words: Enuma Anum, Enlil, Ea, ili” rabdti, ina milki$una kini usurat Samé 0 irsitim iSkund, etc., “when Anu, Enlil and Ea, the great gods, by their legitimate counsel made the forms (images) of Heaven and earth,’ etc. The other, Sumerian, text contains the

same phrase, but in a very corrupted Sumerian, and was evi-

' See also Jensen, KB 6, 1, p. 544 to 4su-gal-an-zu.

dently wrongly reproduced by the pupil; it runs: G an-na! “en-lil-l4! “en-ki dingir[-gal-gal-e-ne| malga’-ne-ne-gi-na-ta®? me-gal-gal-la[..... ie

In all instances where the works of creation are referred to, Anu as well as Enlil is credited only with the creation of the universe in general or, to use the Babylonian term, of Heaven and earth, but no special creative work within the universe 1s ascribed to either of them, at least not in the material known to us. Enki, however, is credited, e. g., in Weissbach, Miscellen 12, with the creation of the aps, the brick god, vegetation, mountains, seas, the king and mankind, etc. The reason for this is evidently’ that Enki is a god of wisdom and clever designs, qualities which are indispensable to a god who is to create complicated organisms such as living beings, etc. It will be observed that in this respect Enki and Nin-harsag are deities of a kindred character, and we may suppose that this somehow or other must have led to contradictory or at least parallel accounts of the creation. In our text this difficulty is entirely avoided by the general statement that

mankind was made by the four creators.

So far as we know of Anu's and Enlil's character, it is not likely that there ever existed the belief that they tried their hand at special creative acts requiring any display of wisdom and skill. Their share in the creation of mankind consisted probably in the mere expression of their desire to have the earth peopled with living beings while they left it to the other gods, especially to the gods of wisdom and skilled handicraft, to devise the necessary means and to execute their wishes. Indeed the ordinary procedure in all that is done by the ruling god is that he convenes the assembly of the gods to ask their

1 The a after an and "enlil is entirely uncalled for.

2MAL+GA = malga is loanword from the Semitic milku; for the pronunciation, see eit? So Ata:

' The pupil made the mistake of following the position of the words in Akkadian; Sumerian the sequence of the words is of course, malga-gina-(a)nene-ta. See U.M. Chapter I, Grammatical Texts.

advice which he is likely to follow, and evidently the procedure '1 the creation will not have made an exception to this rule. Note that CT 13, 34 states expressly that the gods in their assembly created Heaven, earth and all things,! and that according to the practice tablets above quoted, Anu, Enlil and Ea frst deliberated with one another before they began the work of creation. Thus also Marduk in the epic Enuma eli§ first communicates his plan to create man to the gods," and, although the following part of the poem is most fragmentary, yet enough remains to show us that Ea aids him with his counsel and perhaps this god and eventually another deity even actually effected the creation of man, though the process of substituting Marduk in the rdle of older gods may very well have already

been carried so far as to ascribe to him the actual creation of man, which would be quite possible since Marduk is a god of wisdom.

As the relation between Nin-harsagga and Enki, so also that between An and Enlil with regard to their respective part in the creation of man is left entirely undetermined by the general character of the statements in our text. There is no doubt that either god must have played about the same rdle as the other, since both are essentially ruler-deities; the difficulty which naturally arises from this fact, was, however, overcome by the doctrine that the power of the supreme god might be exercised by another ruler-god in consequence of the former's resolution to confer his own power upon the other, thus making him the legitimate ruler. The epic Enuma eli§ therefore relates at length how the Anifitu, 7. e., the supreme power and functions of Anum, was conferred on Marduk; and although as yet we have no direct testimony for a similar legal transfer of Anu’s power to Enlil, yet the constant association of Anu and Enlil in the inscriptions and the fact that the term Enlilftu expresses on the whole the same idea as Anfitu, leave no doubt that

1 E-nu-ma ili™ i-na bu-uh-ri-Su-nu ib-nu-u [..... bas [se tc:
® Tablet VI, at the beginning.

the doctrine above referred to was likewise applied to the rela-tion between Enlil and Anu, 7. e¢., that Enlil became “the Anu,” as Marduk later became “‘the Enlil.’”” This latter relation has often been conceived as an identification of Marduk with Enlil, and here, as in many other cases, the tendency to identify dis-tinctly separate gods has played a somewhat unfortunate part. . That here we have a relation quite different from what is implied by the term “identical,” is clearly shown by the fact that although Enlil acts in the character of Anu, and Marduk later in the character of Enlil, yet Anu as well as

Enlil never ceased to be distinct and independent gods and what is more, always remained the highest of the gods and the ultimate legal source of divine power. A most instructive illustration of this conception is, e. g., the beginning of the inscriptions of Samsuiluna LIH 97-09, according to which An and Enlil look favorably upon Marduk, confer the lordship over the four quarters of the world upon him, etc., wherea:; Marduk, who is now “the Enlil of his land,’’! entrusts the shepherding of the land, etc., to Samsuiluna, the human ruler. It is clear that Marduk simply acts as Enlil by performing his functions as ruler, but he is as little identical with Enlil as Samsuiluna with Marduk. Our own text is likewise an example for this peculiar theological problem, for throughout the tablet neither An nor Enlil is mentioned alone,? though six times their names are mentioned together (113 31819 410 637); Moreover, it will be observed that in 6s5 the verbal forms of which an-‘en-lil is the subject, are in the singular, so that it is very likely that an-“en-lil has to be translated “the Anu Enlil,” 7. ¢., Enlil representing not only his own power, but also the authority of An. Viewed from a literary point of view this combination of the names of the two gods evidently indicates a conscious blending of two separate versions of the deluge story, one with Anum and the other with Enlil as the chief god. It may be recalled that,

1L1. 17, 18: Cen-lil kalam-ma-na = “en-lil ma-ti-Su.
2 Except An in zi-an-na zi-ki-a 6).

according to the introduction to the deluge story which 1s ‘nserted in the Gilgame’ epic, Anu is the supreme deity, “‘the father of the gods; yet later on Enlil alone appears as the ruler of the gods, a clear indication that also in this account two separate versions, one with Anum and one with Enlil as the chief deity, have been fused into one. As a version which recognizes Enlil alone as the ruling god, the Atra-hasis epic may be cited, in which Enlil is described as the father of the

gods, that is, he is here given also the title and the position which Anu holds in the version of the GilgameS epic. At the present we know unfortunately almost nothing of the various forms in which the story must have been told at the various Babylonian sanctuaries; but from the above remarks we may at least conclude that there existed at Uruk and other sacred cities of Anu a version in which Anu still figured alone in his supreme power.

As we have seen that Nin-harsag also was a ruler-deity, the question may be asked as to whether perhaps a version of the creation story did not exist in which she not only appeared ‘1 the réle of Enki as the wise maker of human beings, etc., but at the same time in the rdéle of Enlil and Anu. This question, however, cannot be answered with the help of our present material. An indication might perhaps be seen in the repentance of Belit-ili in the deluge story of the Gilgames epic for having spoken unfavorably of mankind in the assembly of the gods and having ordered a “fight”? to destroy her people;? this incident may very well have been taken from a version in which Nin-harsag played a more prominent part than she does in the present form of the epic.

The post-positive element a-ba after mu-un-dim-e8, in |. 14’, has the force of a verbal conjunction meaning “after,” “when”

1 Gilg. Ep. XI, 15.
2 Gilg. Ep. Xi.

(with pluperfect). It seems to me that ba contains the demonstrative element bi and the locative element a = “upon (the SeGULrenae<Ol) sthiss s. fs. , the first a being probably identical with the relative a which gives definite verbal forms the force of a noun; possibly we may have to render the demonstrative

idea of bi by adding a “thus” : “after thus they had created.’”! Whether, on the other hand, it has some connection with the dialectical substantive a-ba (for a-ga) = ar-ka-tum 5 R Ilo, must remain doubtful for the present.2

Line 15 evidently related a special work of creation which was achieved between the creation of man and of the animals: but as it is not possible to identify with certainty the second sign of the word nig-x which denotes the object of this creative act, | cannot offer a definite suggestion for the meaning of this line. In 6, we find nig-x in the genitive : mu-nig-x-ma, “the Da Ce tethieeca sas ps , from which we can probably conclude that the phonetic value of the unidentified sign ended with m. In 6, the ma after nig-x seems to be a mistake of the scribe and to have therefore been erased. Unfortunately also the exact meaning of the following word ki-ta, “that which is below,” in our passage is not quite clear: perhaps “ground” or “depth (of the ground or the waters?);” apparently the first ki-ta forms a genitive to nig-x, while the following ki-ta seems to be subject or secondary object of mu-dib-dib. Accord-ing to our passage the nig-x is the product of the ki-ta: accord-ing to 6; it rises up from something, perhaps from the waters of the flood; it seems to play some important part in the salvation of Ziugiddu, for according to 6, if this passage Is correctly inter-preted, it is given the name “‘which saved the seed of mankind.”

‘ It will be possible to determine the exact meaning of -aba only after we have material at our disposal.

In the passage Rim-Sin, stone tablet, @-a-ni nig d-wl-li-a-ta!® ba-dii . a-ba ba accordingly, take a-ba either as post-positive conjunction and connect it with t ba-di: “his house which, after it had been built in old times, had been destroye might take it as an adverb and connect it with the following verb, “which had be later on had been destroyed.’ In view of the use of aba as a post-positive eleme the first explanation is perhaps preferable, though by no means certain.

As Zi-ugiddu prostrates himself before Enlil after the nig-x has risen (from the waters?), it probably is in some way or other connected with the presence of Enlil, and therefore we might perhaps think of some such meaning as “land,” “‘stretch of land,” though other meanings as, @. &., “vegetation, etc., are quite possible.

Dib-dib perhaps = du88i, “to cause to be abundant,”’ “to cause to sprout up;” or = Sfiituqu, etc.’

For references to the creation of the animals see C1I13, 34(DT41)s,4: bu-ul séri [u-ma-a]m SErlig Aj ae rm <GaIMT 3) m3 552: MAS-ANSU nig-zi-gal edin-na ba-di = bu-ul séri Si-kin na-pis-ti ina si-e-ri ib-ta-ni. According to our passage the animals were created after man just as in the second Biblical creation story in Genesis 2; we may conclude that this was likewise the order of the creation in the epic Enuma eli8, for Marduk’s speech at the beginning of the sixth tablet refers to the creation of man only, and the animals, therefore, will have been created only after man that he might rule over them. The text CT 13, 34,, mentions the animals of the plain before the namassé ali, ‘the city tribes,” 7. e., “men,” but in this passage animals and men are taken together as Siknat napisti, “living creatures,’ inl. 3, and the writer of the text therefore may not have intended to observe a strict chronological sequence in these details. “{niCh13) 353955 aed thesaeas (secmeic plain are created after men: moreover, it will be observed that in this text those beasts which live in the river marshes and on the mountains are created even later, because marshes and mountains were made later than the level country in which the creation of man and the animals of the plain took place.

COLUMN 2

The broken lines in the upper part of the preserved portion of Column 2 again contain a direct quotation in which, as in Column 1, a deity explains his intentions with regard to some subject, as will be seen from the fact that the verbal forms

begin with ga, “I will.” There is not enough preserved to make out the general trend of the speech, but from the recapitulation in Il. 8-10 it follows that it referred to the establishment of the kingdom which was bestowed upon one of the created men. The statement as to what god is speaking, is not preserved, but as will be seen further below, there is little doubt that it was the Anu Enlil. The recapitulation is followed, in l. 11, by the phrase garza-me-mah 8u-mi-ni-ib-Su-dt referring to the effective establishment by this god of the divine laws by which the kingdom existed.!

The following lines, 12-19, refer to the founding of five -cities and their bestowal upon certain gods who are called kab-du-ga’s, a term which later on is also used of the amaru, the deluge demon. As the first of these cities is Eridu, the city of Nudimmut or Enki, it is clear that somewhere in the preceding, but now missing portions of the text, the founding of Uruk, the city of Anu, and of Nippur, the city of Enlil, must have been reported, and it would be natural that the first institution of the kingship, which is the subject of the preceding lines, is connected with the founding of these cities of the ruling gods, since according to the belief of the Babylonians the human king officiated as the vicegerent of the god of domination. We may recall in this connection that according to Berosus, who in every point follows the traditions of the Marduk cult, Alorus, the first of the prediluvian kings, was a Chaldean from Babylon, the city of the creator Marduk.? It is very likely that this version of the beginning of the history of Babylonia, which, of course, shows the influence of the theology of Babylon, had superseded an older tradition which located the first king in the city of the god who was then the supreme ruler-deity, namely,

Anu or Enlil. A strong support, if not the final evidence,

1 Concerning the first institution of the Babylonian kingdom by a god compare th
tion from Abydenus' "History of the Chaldeans" in Eusebius' Chronicon (Syncellus
Baotretoat b€ THS xHpas mpOTov A€yer GAwpov Tov b€ vrép EwiTOd Adyov diadodvat O
uv TOV AE® rrowneva O Oeds azrodeiEar.

* Eusebius, Chronicon, Chapter I, after Apollodorus (excerpt in Syncellus): d&Aw

éx BaBvdAwvos yaXddatov.

for our conclusions concerning the founding of Uruk and Nippur before Eridu and the other sacred cities may be found in the fact that in the creation text CT 13, 35f the sacred cities are built in the following sequence: first Eridu, the city of Ea, Marduk's father, |. 12, Babylon, the own city of Marduk, I. 14, and only then after the creation of mankind, animals, vegeta-tion, bricks, etc., Nippur, the city of Enlil, 1. 39, and Uruk, the city of Anu, |. 40. The tendency to have the city of the supreme god founded first is made here the more conspicuous by the fact that the text originally, before it was adapted to the requirements of the Marduk worship, conceded the first place among the gods to Enlil, and the glory of being founded first to the city of Nippur; for in that part of the text which emphasizes the original non-existence of the sacred cities, their sequence is Nippur, |. 6, Uruk, |. 7, and Eridu, |. 8, while no mention at all is made of Babylon. But even in this earlier form of the text we may already trace the same tendency; for the fact that Enlil's city Nippur is built before that of the highest god Anu, can be accounted for only on the assumption that the original text was written at a time when Enlil, not Anum, was the supreme ruler of Babylonia.!

15 R44, Column 2:7 mentions a king LAL-tr-alim-ma (translated DU-GA(=tab-ut-li-

“enlil) who according to 5 R 47, Rev. 5 dwelt in Nippur (a-sib Nippuri*’). As we
a post-diluvian dynasty of Nippur, there is a possibility that he is the first p
whom Enlil established at Nippur immediately after he had founded this city. In
name of the first king Aloros might very well be abbreviated and corrupted from

Apart from the poetical composition 4 R 60*(67) A—G, which depicts the suffering
ur-alimma, and of which 5 R 47 is a commentary, LAL-ur-alimma is mentioned in li
reverse of the text published by King in STG II, pp. 216 and 217, where instead
AMAR-+SE at the beginning of the line the original has’evidently the sign LAL. T
which as far as | know has hitherto escaped observation, runs:

2 LAL! : da-a-bi : Gr : ut!-lum : Allimaesencliliead 12 oe hee. Se eee ae |
3 mu-su-u $a Sar nippur! ~SUILZM US! Gale awd Sean et ee re |
4 GIS-MES-ki-inspiarae: huslacme sly 6 ee ee |
Ekisin-gi “nippurm eat 4 sacladal eee eee ee el eee |

Note that here LAL-ur-alimma is evidently king of Nippur according to |. 3, and
(= kengi) is equated with Nippur, so that the historical titles ‘“‘en of Kengi’”
denote domination over Nippur and evidently claim to be a renewal of the title o
after the creation. We may conclude from this that the Sumerian equivalent for S

in |. 3, with which |. 2 must have closed, was lugal-ki-in-gi-ra.

Judging from the order in which the gods rank in our
text, it might be expected that the city b&ad-NAGAR+DIS"
in I. 16 was the sacred and chief city of the goddess Nin-harsag;
but as the name of the city and that of the deity to whom the
city 1s given are otherwise unknown, it is impossible to come
to any conclusion on this point.

The city of Larak, which is bestowed upon the god Pa-
bil-har-sag, is, of course, identical with Larancha!, which accord-
ing to Berosus was the seat of the last three prediluvian kings,

or at least the seat of Amempsinos and Otiartes, since it is not expressly stated that Xisuthros, the son of Otiartes, lived in Larancha. The name of the city is here written phonetically la-ra-ak without the determinative ki: as “la-rak, the city, is mentioned in the Assyrian eponym chronicle under the second year of King Sanherib. According to the syllabaries la-rag and

la-ra-ag are the phonetic readings of 4 4 48 and ATA BE SET

i. e., lara’(g) and lara-4(g)"'. In the former writing the city Is several times mentioned in Persian times in the business documents of the house of MuraS at Nippur (BE X, 3 65,8, 377, 4169, 887, 1015; PBS II, 1815,7), and from this source we gather the important information that the city was situated on the old Tigris.” Since the former course of the Tigris is approxi-mately represented by the Satt-el-Hai, which leaves the present Tigris at Qut-el-Amara, the site of the city of Larak may be looked for in one of the tells in the vicinity of that water-course, not far from the place where it comes nearest to Nippur. The supposed “ideographic writings” of the name are in reality old phonetic writings 14-l4"(g) and 14-14-4"\(g), which show the same phonetic relation to the later pronunciation larak, as, é. g., the pronunciation illag shows to uruk.*? These writings

‘ Eusebius, Chronicon, Chapter I (Syncellus): €« Aapayywv; variant of the Armeni version: Lanchara, Chanchara, Ilanchara.

PBS II, 18157 : 84 ina ali larak™' ki8ad ™"idiglat la-bi-ri; BE X, 36s : 84 kiSa la-bi-ri $4 ina larak"', etc.

* In the name of this city we have an interchange of I, n and r: unu(g), uruk, i same change in idigna, idiglat and tigris. The second of the above-mentioned wri 14-14-4(g)“", seems to indicate that the stress was on the second syllable, as i by the nasalization of the x in the Greek Aapayya.

evidently go back to a very old time, possibly even before the Sumerians occupied Babylonia, although it is quite conceivable that the change of the second | to r took place within the older Sumerian period.

The chief deity of Larak, Pa-bil- Hate Ssa0 wis) SOmial asia know, ey mentioned again in the inscriptions outside our passage.' This seems to indicate that the tradition concerning Larak goes back to a very remote period. The city was evidently destroyed in that early time, and as it is not before the neo-Babylonian period that the place is again mentioned, we may assume that throughout the earlier periods of Babylonian history it lay in Tuins and was known only as a till abtibi or a "'deluge ruin.'

Sippar, the fourth of the prediluvian cities, is mentioned in the extracts from Berosus, under the designation Todus ALOU cistrapa,? as the place where the 'scriptures' were buried before the deluge? As En-me-dur-an-ki, who is doubtless identical with Evedorachos, the seventh of the prediluvian rulers, 1s a king of Sippar,' it follows that Pantibiblon or Pautibiblon," the city of Evedorachos, is identical with Sippar, provided, of course, that Berosus' words have been correctly rendered by his excerptors. In this case Pautibiblon is perhaps corrupted from Par-kib-nun, which might be the phonetic reading of the signs with which the name of Sippar is usually written.

1 An identification with the similar name "pa-bil-sag is, of course, impossible our passage is correct. What Pa-bil-har-sag's relation was to the "Lady of Larak aX!_oe) who is mentioned SBH 49; 51 Obv.u; 52 Obv.u, cannot be ascertained.

2 Eusebius, Chronicon, Chapter III (Syncellus): €v roAe. 7ALov ovomapos (= ormTa ibidem: €k gur7rapwv.

3 The scriptures are buried in order to preserve the revelations concerning the world, and especially concerning the human arts, vocations, etc., for the post-d The burial of the scriptures is therefore a parallel to the report in the versio

that Ut-napistim took on his boat all kinds of artisans or learned men (maré?! u
the arts could be transmitted. It is evidently for this reason that this version
the burial of the scriptures, which seems, moreover, originally to have been the
of Sippar only. The version of Berosus, on the other hand, for the same reason,
report concerning the saving of the artisans.

4Zimmern, Ritualtafeln 241,93.

> Syncellus: Pantibibla and Pantibiblia.

Ay t(PORBEL-—-CREATION AND DELUGE, TEXT 45

Surruppak, modern Fara, finally, is the well-known city of
Ut(a)-napistim, the hero of the deluge story in the Gilgames
epic. Whether, however, it is the city of Ziugiddu also, is not
evident from the preserved portion of the tablet, but the fact
that Surruppak is mentioned as the last of the prediluvian cities,
may very well point in this direction. For it is quite possible
that the enumeration of the seven prediluvian cities not only
reflects the rank of the gods by whom they were ruled, but also
denotes, at least in some of the versions, the sequence of the
various prediluvian dynasties. We are, however, not able
to prove this point from what at the present is our only source,
namely, the extracts from Berosus, in which only three cities
are mentioned in the order, Babylon—-Sippar(?)—Larak.

The deity of Surruppak is written with the same signs
as the city,! a phenomenon which we may likewise observe
in the writing of “en-lil and EN-LIL", “nina and nina", “iSkur
and ISKUR*“; but whether the pronunciation of the name
of the deity corresponds to that of the city, we do not know.
According to the list An | “a-nu-um, CT 24, 5 Col. 23 and 22,0,,
“SU-KUR-RU is a name of Ninlil.

Lines 20 and 21, which form the transition to the next
work of creation, again take up the sentence begun in |. 13
and interrupted by the explanatory sentences 14-10.

The exact meaning of the last two lines of Column 2 (ll. 22 and 23) and even the grammatical analysis of the first of these lines is still doubtful; but it seems to me that the passage

1 The form and arrangement of the signs vary considerably. In the oldest texts w a single sign which is compounded of SU?, KUR and RU (SU?+KUR+RU); cf. REC 190 8 in SBH 815 = CT16, 36;, the two signs LAM+KUR and RU (LAM+KUR-RU", Semitic equivalent Su-ru-ub-ba-ak); in our text, CT 11, 492 and SBH 82, three signs SU-K (SU-KUR-RU™ = 8u-ru-ub-bak; “SU-KUR-RU SBH 821).

The signs LAM+-KUR-RU™ have also the phonetic value aratta when they are the “‘i gram” for kabtum “mighty,” “‘lofty,’’ Smith, Misc. Texts 25, 26, Obv.4;; for ara word of the same meaning, ibid.4s; for tanadatu “‘loftiness,”’ “splendor,” “‘glo and for tanittu 84 §4-ri-..[...] “splendor,” “loftiness” of ..... , CT 109, (SAI 6813). The first element of this value is evidently identical with ar or ar ri(t)?) = tanittum “glory,” etc. As far as we know there is no city Aratta (Zimm Pp. 533), although aratta, “the lofty one,’’ may very well have been a byname of or was aratta the name of the deity DINGIR-SURRUBBA(K)?

deals with the creation of rivers or canals, and lakes or ponds, if we have thus to translate the word su-luh.' From this we may further conclude that the signs a.an in |. 22 do not repre- sent the ending 4m, but the word Seg, “‘rain,”’ the water of which evidently serves to fill the rivers and the ponds mentioned in the following line. This latter line seems to relate that Enlil placed in these rivers and ponds some objects, called nig-har-har(?), perhaps denoting certain living creatures(?) or the like. That this account of the creation of rivers and ponds follows that of the founding of cities, is easily understood, since the canals, etc., supply the necessary water for the cities and the temples of the gods. The creation of the two large rivers, Tigris and Euphrates, however, had evidently already taken place before any of the cities was built, and therefore must have been related in the upper portion of Column 2 which is now missing; note that also; insG@il 13; 35 -the:creationtom them otis sandsthese ue

phrates is placed between the creation of man and the founding of the cities of Nippur, etc.

COLUMN 3

In the preserved portion of Column 3 the narrative has already turned to the creation story. The few legible words in the broken lines at the beginning evidently refer to the resolution of the gods to send a rainstorm. The first of the lines which are somewhat better preserved, contain an allusion to the screaming and lamenting of Nintu and Inanna_ which we likewise find in almost identical words in the deluge story of the Gilgames epic.?_ It will, however, be observed that in our text the two goddesses are mentioned in reverse order, so that

Cf. Radau, BE XXIX 1, Nos. 2, 310: f-tur-tur-ri Su-luh IU li-bf-in-(§)4, “canals (?) ponds? a man had not made.’”’ (For the negation li in this passage see my fo paper “Die Negation liim Sumerischen”’ inOLZ). The meaning “pond” or “lake”’ wou well suit the passage CH Col. 16 21: mu-ub-bi-ib Su-luh é-ab-zu ‘”‘who made shin lake of E-abzu.” Ungnad’s translation “‘Allerheiligstes”’ is out of question.

, Gilg. Ep. X liz, 118.

the expression “her people’ refers to Inanna, not to Nintu, a fact from which it might be concluded that Inanna or [&tar likewise was credited with the creation of mankind:! but it seems to me that the names of the two goddesses have simply been erroneously interchanged, the version of the Gilgameg epic probably representing the better text.

In the latter version, furthermore, the passage under discussion occurs at the point where the actual beginning of the flood is related, whereas in our text it evidently follows

immediately the resolution of the gods to destroy mankind. Whether it is here or in the GilgameS epic that the passage appears in its original place, depends entirely on its interpretation. According to its present connection in the version of the GilgameS epic it might seem that the screaming of [Star is an expression of anguish, the psychological moment for which indeed would be at the first outbreak of the fury of the storms. The same may be said of Nintu's lament, if this has to be taken in the sense that the goddess begins to repent of her former ill-will against mankind, an interpretation which indeed we find in the direct quotation of her speech in the Gilgame§ epic. But on the other hand, in the lines Gilg. Ep. XI 163-170, which have evidently been taken from another version, Belit-ili, after Utnapistim's salvation, attributes all responsibility for the destruction of the human race to Enlil, a circumstance which seems to suggest that in the council of the gods she had opposed Enlil's proposal to destroy the human race, and from this point of view the lament over the destruction of "her people'' might very well be expected immediately after the final decision of the gods had been made. Whatever the original interpretation of the lament may have been, at any rate the different placing of the passage is again an indication of different versions in the story of the deluge.

In the version contained in the Gilgame§' epic, the lines under discussion are followed by a lament of Belit-ili in direct quotation. The fact that the latter is not found in our text,

1 Cf. Craig, Religious Texts I, 15 Obv.io.

clearly shows that it is taken from a different version, a conclusion which likewise may be drawn from the fact that the direct quotation refers to Belit-ili's lament only, and not also, as we should expect, to iStar's screaming.

It will be noticed that our text, especially at this point, refers to the various incidents of the narrative in a rather short and merely allusive style. This is especially evident from the following line, according to which Enki secretly conceives a plan the contents of which is not betrayed to the reader, although there can be no doubt that he devises a means to frustrate the plan of the gods. What the following lines allude to, however, it is impossible to say, as the ends of the lines are broken, and no other source gives us information concerning ‘ncidents at this juncture of the narrative.

In 1. 20 Zi-Q-GID-du, the hero of the deluge, is introduced. The meaning of his name is evidently “who made life long of days.”? It will be observed .that this name alludes to life or to the soul (zi = napistum) just as does the Semitic name Ut(a)-napistim which the hero of. the known deluge story bears; but so far as we can judge at the present time; there seems to be no correspondence between the other elements of the two names. Our 7i-A-GID-du is, of course, identical with the zicSU-da who is mentioned in CT 18, 30, and rendered ut-na-PAB-HAL-te, 7. ¢., ut-na-pis-te,” in the Semitic column, for we find him there between Gilgames and Engidu, evidently on account of the connection between the hero of the deluge story and the GilgameS legend. It will be noticed that in the last mentioned form of the name the @ has been dropped or rather contracted with the preceding i, that instead of the simple sign siru, we have the sign sirgunt, and lastly that the final y has become an a, which probably gives the name a passive meaning: “Who has been lengthened in life,’ 7. e., “who has

1 1f this explanation is correct O-GI Ddu would be a compound participle ‘time l which, together with the prefixed object zi, again would form a new compound par zi-A-G1 Ddu (in Semitic murrik dm balati). Cf. the similar formation ti-i-SU-du col. 113, 13.

2 Perhaps ut-na-pa-a5-te?

gained long life (for himself).”’ Which of the two names may represent the older form it is impossible to say, both perhaps being due to an artificial etymology by which it was attempted to establish a connection between the name and the experiences of the hero of the deluge story.

The reading of the signs GID and SU in the two forms of the name presents some difficulties. On account of the u at the end of the sign group GID-du one might expect that the first of the two signs represents a value containing an u, and since we find the sign SU in the other form of the name, as well as in the phirases. ti-dz5U-du,- BE XXIX & Col. -tig,4, bal-0-bi-SU-SU-du, HGT 74, Col. 2,;, nam-ti-la-ni he-SU Gudea, Statue A, Col. 4,, nam-ti ib-SU-du, AMAR-Sin, Statue B, Rev. 12, and as we doubtless have to read f-mu he-st-su-@ in Warad-Sin, Stone tablet, Rev. 21, it would be very tempting to read our name zi-(i-sa-du.!. But the sign GID on our tablet seems to be quite certain, as may be seen from the enlarged photographic reproduc-tion of the five passages where it occurs, and unless the scribe has made a mistake in all these passages, the only value that could be taken into account, as far as we know at present, would be gid = aradku. Moreover, it will be remembered that both BU and SU have the meaning urruku ‘‘to lengthen,” toemake long: cf. ana ittisu’1. Col. 3:

63°35] nF id oi is-su-uh, i§-du-ud, ur-ri-ik
Sin" "by ib-bu-uh
S7in-SU ur-ri-ik ;

Seen Ameatien Bron andeoise «ea, OU, |ar-rak

, Scheil, ZA IX p. 220, Obv..;. According to the passage last quoted SU had the value gi-di, and if this value be certain,? we might assume that in the passages quoted above we have perhaps to read gid-du instead of sti-du, etc., the root of the word then | being something like gidu. In support of this assumption it may

1 The same was suggested to me by Prof. Zimmern in a letter in which he called m
tion to the above-mentioned passage CT 18, 309,
2 Perhaps zi?-di (for si-du)? Cf. 1. 15 GIS 1 =212)- = SO-SUr

9d 66

perhaps be said that st-(i-da means raiqu “distant, remote’ ’(cf.,
(-sti-ti-da-$a = a-na d-mi ru-qu-ti 4 R9 »,) and that, therefore,
it would be likely that SUD in the meaning ‘‘to be long,”’ etc.,
would have a different value.! Nevertheless, with our present
material it is impossible definitely to decide this question.

Quite in accordance with Berosus’ tradition that Xisuthros
was one of the prediluvian rulers, throughout our text, with
only a few exceptions, Ziugzddu is referred to as king; but at
the same time he occupies a priestly office, namely, that of the
pasisu to some god, whose name is broken Ot linismisevely
unfortunate, for the god’s name would probably have given
us a clue as to the city in which the deluge story was localized
by our text.

Line 21 seems to refer to a famous work which the Baby-
lonians ascribed to Ziugiddu. It will be noticed that the
AN-SAG which he built, is called gtir-gtr, “huge,” the term
also used to describe the boat by which Ziugiddu saved himself,
which according to Berosus measured 5 stadia in length and
> stadia in width. The idea that whatever man in those old
days made was of enormous dimensions, is, of course, closely
connected with the belief in the enormously long lives of men
in those days, and likewise, no doubt, man himself will have
been fancied by the Babylonians then to have been of a much
higher stature than at present. Possibly the AN-SAG which
Ziugiddu built or made was some well-known natural or artificial

landmark which excited the curiosity and fancy of the Babylonians. |

Of especial interest for us are the lines 22 ff, because they represent Ziugiddu as a pious man, a feature which is not found in the Babylonian versions already known, but which has its counterpart in the Biblical statement that Noah was a Just and pious man in his time, Genesis 619; 71.

1 In this case the value su(d) in he-si-st-G (above quoted) and in the rather un passage (i-nam-ti-la-ka-na-SU-U-RI?. DA. BI.U-me-na-sa[-s4..... } = mu-ur-rik O di-Su mu-Sak-Sid ir-n[i-it-ti..... |, 4 R Qs4q, would have to be attributed the two values, a confusion which might very well have been caused by the simila Semitic equivalents of in-sG(-Q) and in-gid, namely uriq and urrik.

The exact meaning and especially the grammatical construction of the last two lines of Column 3 1s not clear to me. The “bringing forth’ of ‘dreams (or a dream) that had not existed before(?),’’ and the invoking or conjuring by the name of Heaven and Earth might still be part of the description of Ziugiddu’s doings, |. 24 perhaps representing him as the first man who tried to find out the will of the gods by means of dreams. On the other hand, we might expect that these dreams had something to do with the following revelation of the resolution of the gods, that is, that they were the means by which Ziugiddu gained knowledge of the impending destruction of mankind. ‘That the story, at least in some versions, was indeed told in this way, we see clearly from I]. 195 and 196 of the account in the GilgameS epic, according to which Ea protests that he has not communicated the secret of the gods to Atrahasis, but has only made him see dreams, so that he “‘heard”’ the decision of the gods.1. Moreover, in the account of Bercsus it 1s expressly stated that Kronos, 7.e., Ea, appeared to Xisuthros in a dream and informed him that mankind would perish by a flood.? As far as we can judge from the preserved text of our tablet, how-

ever, there seems to be no logical connection between the dreams mentioned in |. 24 and the communication of the plan of the gods in Column 4.

1 1%g-na-ku ul ap-ta-a pi-riS-ti_ ilt?! rabdti?! 1at-ra-ha-sis Su-na-ta u-Sab-ri ili?' is-me.

2 In the account of the deluge story in the eleventh tablet of the GilgameS epic been worked together at this point three different versions which can still be v

In the first Ea himself communicates the decision of the gods directly to Ut-nap 23-47), and when later taken to account by Enlil, boldly justifies his course by that it is unreasonable to destroy mankind altogether, instead of simply punishi all sorts of plagues and thus causing them to desist from their evil ways (Il. 1 argument appeals to Enlil and he becomes reconciled to the fact that Ut-napiStim

In the second version Ea is afraid to Act directly against the will of Enlil, an his own promise, not to divulge to mankind the contents of the gods' decision. H sends a dream to Atrahasis, "'the very wise (or clever) one,' and the latter, on cleverness, guesses the impending peril. In this version Ea later justifies hims that he has spoken to no man regarding the plan of the gods, but that "the very the secret from the dream (Il. 195, 196). Note that in this version the hero of

on
iS)

COLUMN 4

The meaning of the first line of Column 4, which is the immediate continuation of the last line of Column 3, is not clear on account of its broken condition; at the end of the preserved part of the line a wall or building (IZ?-SIG) seems to be mentioned, which probably is identical with the wall (iz-zi) men-

tioned in the following lines. The situation in Il. 2 and 3 1s apparently this, that Ziugzddu, while standing beside this wall, hears a voice, which utters the words contained in lines 3 ff. It will, however, be observed that the god by whom Ziugiddu is warned does not address his words to the wall, as he does according to Il. 20 and 22 of the eleventh tablet of the Gilgames epic, but to Ziugiddu himself, the wall being simply the place where the revelation is made. This entirely agrees with the account in the main version! of the story in the Gilgames epic according to which the god Ea addresses Ut-napiStim directly. However, that also in one of the versions upon which our own text is based the wall originally played a more important part, seems to follow from the emphasis laid upon it. It may perhaps be concluded that in a certain Babylonian sanctuary a sacred wall figured as a means of ascertaining future events, and possibly there existed the belief that this wall inspired especially significant dreams in those who slept near it.

For numun-nam-lt-qal, "'seed of mankind," in |. 8, compare CT 13, 35°a-ru-ru numun-"(=nam-li-qal-lu) an-da(™ \ebi-ine mt = *(=a-ru-ru) zi-ir a-me-lu-ti it-ti-Su 1b-ta-nu.

called Ut(a)-napiStim, but Atra-hasis. In Berosus' account that Kronos, 2. e¢., appeared to Xisuthros, this original significance of the dream has already been

In the third version Nin-igi-azag, as Ea is called in this account, relates the reason as in the second version, to a wall (Il. 19-22), and Ut-napiStim thus bec Here Nin-igi-azag must therefore, when taken to account by Enlil, have defended ground that he had not told any man, but a wall, and that thus Xisuthros had hea will be observed that in |. 196 the words piriSti ili iSme, are rather strange i dream; we would expect that "'the very wise one' guesses what is meant by the dr evidently we have a trace of the third version, according to which Utnapistim he to the wall. Did there perhaps exist a tale, according to which the wall in some way passed the secret of the gods on to Ut-napistim? This might perhaps have bee sion to the phenomenon of the echo.

' At least the main version of the story at this point.

Buhrum in bu-th-ru{-um dingir-ri-ne], “assembly of the gods,’ is the Semitic word puhrum; at the time of Hammurabi, and no doubt some time before him, puhrum was the common designation for the city council which was entrusted with the political administration of the city as well as with the rendering of judgment. For the latter cf., e. g., BE VI 2 No. 10, according to which King Hammurabi refers a legal case to the bu-th-ru-um nibru"; it will be observed that this text likewise, although written in Sumerian, uses the Semitic word rather than the corresponding Sumerian ukkin, evidently because puhrum was at that time the technical term for the city council. That the word in our text is also applied to the assembly of the gods, is a good example of the tendency to model everything relating to the gods after human affairs: like men the gods form an organized community. This parallelism is even more evident from the fact that the functions of the assembly of the gods are described in the same technical terms as those of the human city council; e. g., di-til-la, in |. 9, is the common term for the final decision of a court of justice at the time of the kingdom of Ur; cf. also Enuma eliS VI u-Si-bu-ma ina puhri-Su-nu Pea OUl-Uer 6 oa], ‘‘they sat down (for a session),”’ etc., where the technical term aSabu, “‘to sit,’’ “‘to be in session,” is used. For other occurrences of puhrum see, e. g., CT 13, 341, Se eO ie camila DUS -TiSU-NU se 1D-TU-l | oe de], etc. However, it will be observed that the idea of the assembly of the gods becomes prominent only in rather late inscriptions; if this 1s not merely accidental, it might perhaps be taken as an indication of a difference in organization between Sumerian and Semitic communities, at least at the time when the two races were still opposed to each other. Originally, of course, the word puhrum, “‘assembly,’’ must have implied that the whole community took part in the deliberations, and this may very well have been the practice among the Semites, while in the Sumerian cities there seems to have prevailed a more feudal organization under an hereditary iSakku who at the same time often occupied a hierocratical position. Nevertheless, at the

time of the first dynasty the pubrum had already become a select patrician council, for, as the letters of Hammurabi and his successors show, it consists of the so-called judges with a bél térétim, or whatever the designation of this official was, at their head. It is evidently after this patrician body that the assembly of the gods has been modeled.

COLUMN 5

The missing portion of Column 4 must have contained the account of the construction of Ziugiddu's boat. The first lines of Column 5 already depict the flood. The repetition of im-hul in]. 1 expresses the idea "'all;'' dti-a-bi, "they all," is therefore a pleonasm. For im-bul im-hul ... ni-lab-gi-eS, "all the winds

went," 7. e. "blew," |. 1, and f-7-4m gé-7-4m a-ma-ru kalam-ma ba-tr, "seven days and seven nights the rainstorm struck the land," ll. 3 and 4, compare Gilg. Ep. XI 6 ur-ri U mu-%4-a-ti il-lak S4-a-ru a-bu-bu me-hu-u i-sap-pan mata.' The principal destructive force, however, is not the im-hul, "the windstorm," but the a-ma-ru, ''the rainstorm," "rain flood,"' "cloud burst,' which therefore in the summary in Il. 3 and 4 is mentioned alone, the imhullu being mentioned only because a thunder-storm is almost invariably preceded and accompanied by a windstorm. The same two destructive forces we find in the version of the Gilgame' epic designated as Saru and abdabu, meht in Il. 128 and 130 being simply a variant of the latter, as follows from their reversed sequence in the two lines; one of the sources of this account evidently used the word abtbu, another the word mehti for the destructive rainstorm.? Neither the version of the GilgameS epic nor our own text speaks of an

1 For the verb dr (Gru) in ba-an-da-ab-ur-ir, 1. 2, and kalam-ma ba-tr-ra-ta, |.

acteristic of the activity of the rainstorm or rain demon, compare, e. g., Hrozn below: lugal a-ma-iru ba-tr-ta? = beé-lum a-bu-ba-ni8 ib-ta-a', "'the lord like rages; CT 12, 50, Obv. 93 Ur-Ur | Sa-ba-tu Sa ,,(=a-bu-bi), and especially 5 R 4 pa-nu, which latter verb is used in the version of the Gilgame§ epic.

? For another mechanical juxtaposition of two variants see Gilg. Ep. XI "nin-igi é-a, and !'¥adu-u 8#4"ni-sir.

inundation by a rising sea; in this both of the Babylonian accounts agree with the Biblical Jehoistic version of the flood story which knows only of a rain that lasted forty days and forty nights, in contradistinction to the Priestly Code according to which Elohim flooded the earth from below and above by opening the fountains of the great ocean and the windows of Heaven.

According to our text the rainstorm lasted fully seven days and seven nights, I]. 3 and 4, while according to the account in the Gilgames epic its duration was only six days and nights, the rain ceasing at the beginning of the seventh day.! Nevertheless this variation is hardly of any importance when compared with the forty days of rain in the Jehoistic version and the 150 days during which the flood continued to rise according to the Priestly Code.

For bul-bul = naSu, ''to move" (intransitive), in 1. 5, see 4 R 28, 2 iSkur sdr-ra-na ki $i(?)-in- -ga-bul-bul = "adad ina e-zi-zi-SU ir-si-tum i-na-as-su, and Hrozny, Ninrag 2 and 3 Rev. gir-gin-na-zu-St. an-ki a(?)-bul-bul = ina a-la-ki-ka Samu-u irsi-tim i-nu-uS-S0; in these passages naSu, ''to move," is used as a synonym of "'to shake," ''to tremble; but that it can denote the movement of a ship upon or over the water, is shown by Gilg. Ep. Xia Sadu-u """ni-sir ""elippu is-bat-ma a-na na-a-81 ul id-din, '"'the mountain (var. Mount Nisir) caught the ship and did not allow it to move." This verb naSum (2773) 1s, of course, against Delitzsch, HW, p. 454, identical with the verb

nuasu which according to 2 R 35,),; is a synonym of alaku2

The text has clearly im-hul-bul-bul-a-ta; if this is correct
we might either assume that bul-bul-a is a transitive verbal

1 This seventh day is designated as f-mu in I. 130 because the whole day, includ
is meant; "'day" in contradistinction to night is urru, which we therefore find
0 mu-Sa-a-ti.

2 Judging from the occurrence of tuaru and tarum, nudsu would be a characteristi
Assyrian form; note, e. g., that the Assyrian legal documents usually use the ph
di-e-nu da-ba-a-bu la-as-5u, whereas in Babylonian tablets we find ta-a-ri 0 da-
Tuaru is, of course, the infinitive form kaSAdum, not as Delitzsch, HWB p. 703,
formation.

WOE Vig

form without prefix, having im-hul as subject,' or im-bul-bul-
bul-a is a compound passive participle, "wind driven,' here
used instead of a definite verbal form. But it would not be
impossible, though it is not very likely, that the original text
read im-Si-7b-bul-bul ''(the boat) moved (intransitive) (over
the waters). "

The post-positive ta, added to the relative a is here as
elsewhere used as conjunction "'since,'" "'after;' it corresponds
exactly to iStu with relative clause in Semitic Babylonian.
Another example of this construction of ta is "a-ga- -dé* nam-
lugal Su-ba-ab-ti-a-ta "after Agade had taken the kingdom,"
Stele from Telloh, RS 1897, pp. 166 f, col. 4. Compare also
the compounded conjunction egir—ta with relative clause
in 'egir "sin-a-bu-Su ba-G8-a-ta '"'after Sinabusu had died,"
BEV leo Nos

The prominence which the god Sama§ is given in the next lines is quite natural, since during the seven days of the rain-storm the world was covered by darkness, and, moreover, the sun-god, whose light shines everywhere, would be the first to perceive the boat, and to be himself perceived by Ziugzddu. For this reason Ziugiddu prays first to him (1. 10), even before Anu and Enlil, and we may conclude that Sama&, taking pity on him, aids him with his counsel to placate the other gods and especially Enlil.

In the version of the GilgameS epic the adoration scene before the god Sama§ has entirely lost its original color; for when in this version Ut-napiStim opens a nappasum, it is not the sun-god that enters the boat by his rays, but the “daylight,” urru (written t-da), falling on Ut-napistim’s cheek.* Yet in

2 Sinjilar ee verbal forms are not infrequently found in late and corrupt Sumeri texts; cf., e. g., an-ki-a “'!bul-bul in the passage quoted above. But in our ca a correct or at least permitted construction, since the prefix would be clear fr verbal form ba-lr-ra-ta; cf. also f-ma-ma in the next line. Moreover, such incom forms may perhaps be allowed by poetic license.

2 Cf. also the above quoted passage 4R 28, 219 in which bul-bul is likewise conn the element Si(?).

> Gilg. Ep. XI !%ap-ti nap-pa-Sa-am-ma urru im-ta-qut eli dir-ap-pi-ia !’uk-tam-at-ta-Sab a-bak-ki. The words im-ta-qut eli dir-ap-pi-a, by the way, are perhaps 1. 138 eli dGr-ap-pi-a il-la-ka di-ma-a-a.

Aver OE BEL-CREATIONS AND, DELUGE* TEX? oy

I. 137 we still find an indication of the original form of the story in the feature that Ut-napiStim throws himself down, uk-tam-mi-is, which corresponds to our KA-ki-su-ub-ba-tim, and, moreover, does not fit very well the immediately following at-ta-Sab, “I was sitting.’’ The reason for this alteration in the version of the Gilgame§ epic is obvious; for if Sama’ noticed

the boat, he (and therefore the other gods) would at once be aware of Utnapistim's escape, which would not be in harmony with the feature later mentioned that the gods are drawn to the ship by the pleasant smell of the offerings; nor would there be time enough left for the sending out of the birds, which according to Il. 140-146 takes place fully seven days later. For the same reason, on the other hand, the feature of the sending out of the birds cannot have existed in our own text, as, moreover, is clearly shown by the fact that immediately after the adoration before Sama§, or more likely, in the intention of the author, at the same time, Ziugiddu offers up his sacrifices, which latter action in the version of the Gilgame' epic follows the bird scene.

So far as we can judge, the adoration scene and the offering up of the sacrifices take place, according to our text, in the boat itself, which evidently is supposed to be still floating on the waters. No doubt this was likewise the assumption in one of the versions which have been fused into the present account of the flood in the Gilgames epic, for according to Il. 198-200 Enlil, after his anger has subsided, with no plausible reason boards the boat, where he seizes Ut-napistim by his hands and bestows eternal life upon him and his wife.! This, of course, is not quite in harmony with the previous statement,

1 Gilg. Ep. XI 8i-lam-ma "enlil a-na lib-bi elippi is-bat ga-ti-ia-ma ul-te-la-a
2004§-te-li uS-tak-mi-is sin-ni8-ti ina i-di-ia, etc. Ul-te-la-an-ni and u&-te-l
difficulty; a translation such as "'he led me out (of the boat),'' or Ungnad's t
mich ans Land,'' is very doubtful, because Silt has the meaning "to lead out of
only in cases where "'to lead into something" is expressed by Sirudu; Sali on th
means "'to take aboard (a vessel); cf., ilamma, |. 198. It would therefore seem
verbs are either taken from a different context or represent an attempt to harmo
statement that Enlil goes aboard the boat with the previous statement that Ut-na
already left it before by the assumption that Enlil leads Ut-napiStim back to th

that Ut-napiStim offered up his sacrifices on the peak of the mountain where the boat had landed, a feature which is evidently taken from a different version.

The boat in which Ziug:ddu saves himself is designated as ""md-gtr-gtir. The same word, but written ma-gur-gur, is used in the fragment of the Semitic deluge story from Nippur which was published by Prof. Hilprecht.!. In this latter form we find it also in the syllabary K 4378, etc. (Col. 5, 1. 15),2 where it is rendered in the Semitic column SU-rum, 7. e., magurgur-rum. The word has, of course, nothing to do with ®"m4-tru = magurru,' which denotes the barges of the gods; as our text shows, the second element is gtr-gtir(-ra) = kabbarum, ely great,'* *"md-gtir-gtir therefore corresponding to the

""elippu ra-bi-ta in |.-6 of the fragment just quoted.

The element ra in the verbal form im-ma-ra-é, L 6, 1s probably the same as in ba-ra-é = i-ta-si.

There can hardly be any doubt that the sentence in 1. 7 relates that Ziugiddu makes an opening in the roof or in one of the walls of the boat, through which, according to the following lines, the rays of the god SamaS can enter. As according to Gilg. Epic XI,35 Ut-napistim opens a nappa'u, we may conclude that KA?-BUR in our text has the same meaning and is identical with the KA-BAL =nappagu in 5 R 39, 23: 42,134 Which probably is a mistake of the copyist for KA-BUR. From the occurrence of nappasu outside the deluge story it would appear that its meaning is simply "'hole' and the verb U would then evidently be bur(u) = pala8u, ''to make a hole.''® The literal translation of I. 7 then would be: Ziugiddu dug a hole (with,

e., through) the boat.®

1 BE Ser. D, Vol. V, fasc. 1.

? Delitzsch, AL', pp. 86-90.

* This is assumed by Hilprecht, BE Ser. D, Vol. V, fasc. I, pp. 52-55.

“Cf. Br. 10181, 10211.

® PilSu is a hole which is dug through something, e. g., through the wall of a h
which is dug in something, e. g., in the ground, is hurru, etc. In Sumerian both
by U = bu-ru = = pilsu, palasu and hurru, hararu.

* Or perhaps: “‘he perforated the boat with a hole.”

The ending en in ba-an-tu-ri-en in 1. 8 is perhaps simply a mistake.

The phrase KA-ki'-su-ub—ttm means literally, ‘‘to perform the kissing of the ground,” 7. ¢., “to worship,” ‘‘to do homage (before somebody)” and finally, ‘‘to pray humbly (before a deity)”; cf. 2 R 47 **KA-ta-su-ub | ka-ra-bu, “to worship,’ na-Sd-qu, “to kiss,’ and 4 R 9 *™ki-a mu-un-su-ub-su-ub = qaq-qa-ru u-na-Sd4-qu. Outside the Eme-sal texts the stem sub is usually written with the sign KA + SU(?)?; cf. sub-bi = ikribu, “homage,” “prayer”; sub-sub = Sukinnu, “to humble oneself (before somebody),”’ “to do homage’; and especially the phrase sub—tim, “‘to perform the proskynesis,”’ and “to pray (before a deity)’: 1 “ninni nin-a-ni “mu-na-an-gin **sub-mu-na-tim (follows direct quotation), Utu-hegal; 2 “lugal-ba-ga-ra mu-na-gin sub mu-na-tum, Gud. Cyl. A, etc. For the meaning of KA-ki-su-ub—tim, cf. also Berosus’ report that Xisithros, after the ship had landed, disembarked, and aposkuyynoavta tyv ynv and having erected an altar, disappeared. :

With gt im-ma-ab-gaz-e | udu im-ma-ab-Sar-ri in |. 11 compare Gilg. Ep. XI “.... ud-dib-bi-ih alpé” | aS-g1-18 [immeré]”. Sadr is here evidently synonym of gaz; or does it have its usual meaning, ‘“‘to make abundant?”

COLUMN 6

The rest of Column 5, now missing, may have dealt with the arrival of the other gods, but this is by no means certain. In the opening lines of Column 6 one of them® seems to be speaking to Ziugiddu and his companions, advising them to invoke Anu and Enlil by the soul of Heaven and Earth for the accomplishment of some purpose which is not clear to me. The

1 The ki is quite plain in 510.
7 KA+KU?
’ Or perhaps still Sama§?

form ni-p4-dé-en-ze-en is the second plural of the future tense of the active theme in-pa (ni-pa).’”!

The exact meaning of the following line which again contains the word nig-x, and its connection with the preceding or the following are not quite clear tome. For the first part of the line compare Col. 1%. The verbal form 1m-ma-ra-é-dé would correspond to Semitic illi (illa), “‘he (or it) rises up,” “goes up.” Could this line refer to the rising of the land out of the water, corresponding to i-te-la-a na-gu-u, Gilg. Ep. XI 140, and nig-x(-ki-ta?) therefore be an expression for land? At least it would seem natural that Ziugiddu, when approaching land, should prostrate himself, according to the following line, before Enlil, the lord of all the lands.

As in the version of the Gilgames epic, so here, according to ll. 7-10, Enlil? bestows eternal life upon Ziugzddu. Note in both cases the comparison of this eternal life with that of the gods: dingir-dim, Column 6s; ki-1 ili” na-Si-ma, Gilg. Ep. XI 203.3 The words of Enlil are apparently spoken while

Ziugiddu is prostrated before him. A reflection of the same situation in one of the sources of the account in the Gilgames epic may be seen in the fact that according to |. 200 Enlil causes the wife of Ut-napiStim to prostrate herself at the latter's side:. uS-tak-mi-is sin=nis-ti ina=1-di-a; note that the verb kamdsu here as well as in 1. 137 (aktamis) corresponds to KA-ki-su-ub—tum.

In the account of the deification our tablet mentions only Ziugiddu, and not his wife, as does the account in the Gilgames epic. But even there it can plainiy be seen that the wife of Utnapistim was mentioned only in some of the versions upon which this account is based, since in |. 199 Ut-napisStim alone is referred to, while his wife is not introduced before |. 200 and then only in a rather awkward manner; and furthermore,

1]t would not be altogether impossible, however, that it is the 2 pl. of the pe ni-pa, and then might mean "'you have been invoked,"' "'you are invoked."

2 More accurately the Anu Enlil.

° In the Semitic text the plural is used because the comparison refers to Ut-nap his wife.

although the following lines 201-203 refer to Ut-napiStim and his wife in the plural, the closing lines of the poem (ll. 204, 205) again return to the singular, referring to Ut-napistim alone. Berosus' account of the deluge bears testimony to the existence of a third version according to which the gods bestow divinity even upon Xistithros' daughter and the steersman of the boat.

The last section of the preserved portion of Column 6, beginning with I. 10, evidently corresponds to the closing lines of the account in the GilgameS epic which tell us that the gods

took Ut-napisStim to a distant place at the mouth of the rivers, but the particulars of the text are not all clear at the present. Numun-nam-lt-qal-iiru'(-(S)a), ""who (or which) saved the seed of mankind," might be a by-name of Ziugzddu, unless it is the name of the nig-x.2, Note that in the fragment of the deluge story published by Prof. Hilprecht, the deluge boat is given a similar name, namely, na-si-rat na-pis-tim.' Mu-un-ti-eS, "they caused him to dwell," |. 12, corresponds to uS-te-Si-bu-in-ni, they caused me to dwell,' Gilg. Ep. XI, 1. 205.

If the fourth sign in line 12 is identical with the Assyrian signs NI-TUK,* the place to which the gods took Ziugiddu after eternal life had been bestowed upon him would be the kur-tilmun-na which:in the writing kur-tilmun™ occurs also in ASK 213, and there is rendered in the Semitic interlinear translation by Sada tilmun, ""Mount Tilmun.'> From _ the

1 The sign is clearly SES.

2 Cf. mu-nig-x-ma, 'the name of the nig-x;'' but in this case one would expect a ""'he called (the name, etc.)."

3 Read Felippu] Si-i lu ®Sm4-gur-gur-ma! Sum!-Sa! lu na-si!-rat na-pis-tim. 'The same ship shall be a magurgurru (giant boat) and its name shall be 'Which saved

4 The first part of the sign is rather effaced, but it seems to be SAL; the seco probably tug, but it might be kin, or, if the perpendicular pressed wedge does n to an erasure, KAB(TUG). For the assumed identity of the sign with the signs NI- that in 157 Column fy it has the form #}& (in é-SAL-TUG-na, a temple of [Star at pare also that the archaic sign KAK+GIS, "'battle mace," in the second half of t appears as SAL+GIS, NIN and DAM! On the other hand, there is a sign KAK-+KAB; cf a: £,. BEV 12 No: 30, séal:

6 37PU-kur-NI-TUK*!-ka sag-ma a-ba-ni-in-[.....] = ina bur-ti Sa-di-i dil-mun qa-du am-si, "in the cistern (or pond) of Mount Tilmun | washed my head."

inscriptions we see that Tilmun must have been situated in the South outside of Babylonia proper. It is usually assumed that it was situated on an island about thirty miles from the shore of the Persian Gulf! which in those times extended much further north; but the passage from which this conclusion has been drawn," states merely that King Uperi of Tilmun had, like a fish, made for himself, at that distance from the shore, a lair in the midst of the sea, which, of course, proves nothing for the exact position of Tilmun, since it is not stated that Tilmun itself was situated in the sea. Nor does the fact that the inscription found by M. Durand on the Bahrein Island Samak contains the name of the god "in-za-ag, who is probably identical with the god "en-zag of Tilmun,* prove that this island is Tilmun. From Gudea, Statue G, Col. 4749, which mentions the country or the mountains of Tilmun together with the countries or mountains of Magan, Meluhha and Gubi as places which furnished wood for Gudea's buildings and from which Babylonia could be reached by ship, it rather follows that Tilmun was an extensive mountainous district, probably situated somewhere on the shore of the southern section of the Persian Gulf, either in Oman or, what is more likely, in Persia#

According to the deluge story in the GilgameS epic the gods caused the deified Ut-napiStim to dwell at the mouth of the rivers, by which evidently the Tigris and Euphrates are meant. This conception, of course, is not in accordance with the localization of Ziugzddu's abode in the country of Tilmun, nor with the idea prevailing in the,other portions of the Gil-games epic that Ut-napistim lives in a very distant land and that GilgameS has to make a long and perilous journey over high mountains and across the sea before he arrives there.

' Delitzsch, Wo lag das Paradies? p. 178.

* Sargon, Monol. Col. 293-95.

32 R546 = CT 25, 35 Obv.a

* Jensen, in ZA 15, p. 225 ff. thinks that Tilmun is the eastern shore of the Pe
as far as the straits of Hormus, comprising also the province Persis.

There existed clearly two distinct versions concerning Ut-napi§-tim's dwelling place; in the closing lines of the present deluge story in the Gilgame' epic they have been harmonized by adding to ina pi narati the words ina rdqi, "in the distance," which originally represented a variant to ina pi narati, but now imply that the mouth of the river has to be sought at a distance and not on the southern shore of Babylonia itself.

The effaced and broken signs after kur-dilmun-na are perhaps ki-"utu-é, ''a place in the East,' which would very well agree with a localization of the city or country of Tilmun on the eastern shore of the Persian Gulf; but as the traces of the signs are not clear enough it is safer to leave this question undecided.

What the rest of Column 6 may have contained it is impossible to say.

(COLOPHON

The colophon on the left edge of the tablet is unfortunately too much damaged to allow any definite reading at the present except of the name zi-Q-G]D-du. The last of the preserved signs, which follows this name, may be dam, and the signs at the beginning of the line perhaps an "en-..... If, however, the vertical impression at the beginning of the line was intended to form part of a cuneiform character, the first signs might very well be read én "en..... ; In this case our text would evidently form the introduction to an incantation rite, which would indeed be possible, since the recital of traditions relating to events of the

earliest times was believed to give the exorcist supernatural power; and, moreover, we could then easily account for the fact that such unusual stress is laid on the invoking of the name and the soul of Heaven and earth in the course of the narrative. But as the reading 6€n is entirely uncertain, it is impossible, at the present, to come to any definite conclusion.

Tue Poetic FORM OF THE [TEXT

Like all the other known accounts of the creation and deluge in cuneiform script our new text 1s a poetical composition, as will easily be seen from the arrangement of the lines, from the parallelism and especially from the peculiar repetition of certain lines with only a slight variation. As to the arrangement of the lines note, e. g., the distribution of certain metrical unities over two lines, the second of which is indented and not ruled and therefore is merely the continuation of the first; see Is4, Tez) liga, etc... Especially mstructive examples are furnished by lines 2,3 and 2», which are almost identical, the latter, in fact, being merely a recapitulation of the former; for while in the passage first mentioned the verse is placed on a single line, in the latter it occupies one of the double lines just described.

On the other hand, we notice that certain word-groups, by the use of blank spaces between them, are made to fill the whole line, which is the more significant, as many of these lines represent only part of a sentence. We may take as an example of this the four lines 55-., transliterated in the following with the same arrangement of the word-groups as found on the original:

u-imin-am ee-jmin- am
a-ma-ru kalam-ma ba-tr-ra- (ee
“ma-gir-gur a-kal-la im-hul-bul-bil-a-ta
‘Gatu i-im-m4-ra-e an-ki-a u-ma- ma

It will be noticed that each of these lines is divided into two halves by the use of a blank space, and that, moreover, in the first and last lines these halves show parallelism in form as well as in meaning. On the other hand, the blank spaces which we notice in the divisions to the right, are not due to any metrical consideration, but simply to the desire of the scribe not to leave a blank space at the end of the column. A good

example of parallelism between two complete lines 1s found in 63 9: ;

ti dingir-dim m-un-na-si-mu
zi-dari dingir-dim mu-un-na-ab-é-de

Another phenomenon similar to the so-called parallelism, but nevertheless quite distinct from it, is the repetition of certain lines in a somewhat different form; as a rule, the second verse 1s slightly enlarged by the addition of an element more closely defining one of the grammatical units of the preceding verse, usually the first. Cf. lines 2919:

[o1Ss eas -|...-nam-lugal-la_an-ta-é-da-a-ba
fee}. -mah ®* 7°... |-nam-lugal-la\ an-ta-é-a-ba

It will also be observed that this peculiar repetition as well as some of the parallelisms produce a sound effect which in some way may be compared to that of the modern rhyme, though, of course, the actual resemblance between the two phenomena is only a remote one. This effect is very well shown, e. g., by lines 53. quoted above; note here the corre-

spondence of imin-am in the two half verses in |. 3, and of a-ta in the two following verses, examples which approach very closely to actual rhyme.

The poem character of our text finally shows itself in the diction. It has already been pointed out that our text does not relate the various incidents of the story in the quiet and steady progression usually found in historical narrative, but often merely alludes to some striking incident and without wasting any time on details jumps abruptly to some other incident. A good illustration for this is found in the third column, where line 17' merely tells us that Enki held counsel in his heart without betraying what the subject of his deliberations was. Our poem evidently belongs to that class of historical poetry which was not intended to impart new historical information, but rather to review historical facts with which the person who listened to the poem or song was quite familiar. In these features our poem resembles the old Hebrew historical poetry with its merely allusive style, a feature which is very striking in the so-called Song of Deborah, Judges 5, when compared with the simple historical narrative in the fourth chapter.

In this connection | should like to call attention to the comparatively frequent use of the expression t-bi-a or d-ba, "on that day," "at that time,' which is found in 3,; : d-bi-a "nin-ELE eae ¥cinis2-| "eee J; 320: G-ba -zi-Q-GID-du lugal-4m, and the same again in 6,. For this phrase, which directs the attention to bygone days in contradistinction to the present, very well illustrates the purpose just described, namely, to make historical facts pass in review before the listener. This use of f-ba, by the way, is a very common feature of historical poetry, as I hope to show more at length at some other time. Here, however, it may be pointed out that the use of raze "then," "at that time,' in old Hebrew poetry forms an exact parallel to this peculiarity of the Babylonian: for in the Song

of Deborah, e. g., we find the particle used no less than five

times to introduce some striking incident: 5s Dy yw on? INS
5u i OY Dye? TI. IN, “at that time the people of
Jahweh descended to the gates;’’ 513 Dy DAN? er Tiel. 1S;
519 YI 1221 NOMS WW, “at that time the kings of Canaan did

Dates: Manteca DID™ APY TaPJE Ny “at that time the hoofs’

of the horses pawed the ground.’’ From this as well as from
the similarities in poetical form it will be seen that there existed
a very close relation between Israelitish and Babylonian poetry.
These common peculiarities, however, were doubtless not
restricted to these two nations, but will probably be found to
have been characteristic of the poetry of the whole ancient
Orient.

THE AGE OF THE TABLET

As our tablet is not dated, the important question as to
its age can be decided only by the character of the script and
by internal and other indirect evidence.

Notwithstanding its great neatness, the script, owing to

_ OOOOV—

the small size of the signs, 1s of a somewhat indefinite character,
and therefore allows us to fix the time of the tablet only within
certain limits. The widest scope would be between 2300 and

1300, 7. €., approximately from the time of the dynasty of Isin to the end of the Cassite period. It is true, for the. dynasty of Isin and for the first half of the dynasty of Babylon the script of our tablet would be rather advanced, but this might be due to the smallness of the characters, as in such a case the signs show a greater tendency to simplification than in large script which allows sufficient room for all the details of the signs. At least at the time of Rim-Sin, Hammurabi and Samsu-iluna, but also in closely written texts from the time of the dynasty of Isin, each sign represented on our tablet may be found in exactly the same form, as will be seen, e. g., from BE VI, 2, No. 49, which is dated in the time of Samsu-iluna, and from AO 5478, RA 1911, p. 82, dated in the time of Rim-Sin. On the assumption that the scribe wrote carefully, on the other hand, the tablet might very well have been written during the earlier Cassite period, although two or three signs show a more archaic form than we find on any other tablet of the Cassite period. The sign mi, e. g., appears in our text as <BE and <= with three or four horizontal wedges above each other, while the Cassite tablets always have ¢¢= with two wedges only; the sign har is found on our tablet in the form &, whereas the published Cassite texts show either the form 4= or ££. Note also ‚X« and »£« instead of +e and »@&«. But to assign an earlier date to our tablet merely on account of these few indications. which might very well be due to intentional archaism on the part of the scribe, would be rather hazardous, and the more so because in the case of an earlier date we would have to go back at least to the time of Samsu-iluna; for up to the present no Nippur tablet dated between Samsu-iluna and the kings of KarduniaS has come to light, evidently because Nippur was not inhabited during the greater part of this period.

Even less satisfactory, at least for the present, must remain an attempt to find indications of the age of our tablet in the

form of the language. It will be noted that the text is written

in a kind of Sumerian which shows considerable deviation from the idiom used, e. g., in the royal building inscriptions, differences which moreover betray clearly a decay of the language such as we notice, although to a much greater extent, in the very late Sumerian texts of the Assyrian and neo-Babylonian period. Note, e. g., the change of the verbs Su—dt and si—sa into. Su—su-da and si—si-sa: 'and the locative form Sa-ni-te-na-ge instead of Sa-ni-te-na-ka; it has likewise been mentioned that the text has by no means been carefully transmitted, and this as well as the corruption of the language might very well be taken as indications of a late date; but as at the present, for lack of the necessary material, we are not yet able to determine to what extent such deviations in the late Sumerian texts already existed in texts of earlier periods outside the royal inscriptions, this conclusion has only a comparative value. Nevertheless we can say this much, that we are already in a time when Sumerian as a spoken language can have survived only in a more or less corrupt condition; so far as our present material allows us to draw a conclusion on this subject the process of decay seems to have set in during the later period of the first dynasty of Isin.

Nor do we gain a more definite result from internal evidence which, moreover, will prove much less for the date at which the tablet was actually written than for the time of the first composition or at least the last redaction of the text. The fact that our tablet mentions the highest gods in the order An, Enlil, Enki and Nin-harsagga makes it impossible to place the date of the composition of the text at or before the time of Gudea; for we have seen that Gudea still mentions them in the old order An, Enlil, Nin-harsag and Enki. On the other hand, we have seen that a number of kudurru inscriptions which belong to the latest period of the Cassite dynasty and the time of the second dynasty of Isin, enumerate the gods in the same order as our tablet. The time of the latter dynasty, however, would have to be regarded as the lowest limit to which

the composition of the text could be referred, since from that time Marduk begins to rank above the goddess Ninharsagga.

I think, however, the observation that our tablet shows a remarkable affinity to the list of kings which is published as No. 5 of this volume, will lead us a step nearer to our goal. Both tablets are of the same reddish-brown clay, of at least approximately the same size! and the same shape and, what is especially important, show the same peculiarities of writing. For the latter compare, e. g., the combination of the signs an and en into »E4{? with the characteristic development of an into the form of me. It seems to me, therefore, sufficiently certain that the two tablets were written by the same hand and probably were intended to form, together with one or two others, a series of tablets on which the scribe wrote an outline of the history of Babylonia from its earliest beginnings down to his own time. As each column of the king list contained the names of about thirty-nine or forty kings,® the missing portion of the last column cannot have given the names of more than nineteen kings, but in all likelihood much less, as there must have been left some space for the summary and probably a colophon. On a rough estimate the list will thus be carried down to approximately the latter half of the dynasty of Babylon, and this then would likewise be the time when the list as well as the deluge and creation tablet were written.

1 The width of the tablet which contains the list of kings was probably a centim
than that of the creation and deluge text.
2 Not At as Hilprecht's copy shows. For a similar development see BE VI, 2, No.

(Rim-Sin, 2d year after the conquest of Isin); 595 (Samsu-iluna 26th year), both
115512 (Ammiditana 37th year);- 1201 (Ammi.....); 1231415 (Ammizaduga 5th yea
1241418 (Ammi-zaduga 6th year). It will be noted that this form of the combinati
frequent during the last period of the kingdom of Babylon, but it is likewise fo
written literary texts from the time of the dynasty of Isin.

3 As the Babylonians counted 139 kings from the deluge to the end of the dynasty the first three columns must have contained the names of 118 kings (139 kings — Ur and Isin), and each column therefore those of about thirty-nine or forty. Hil judging only from the reputed size of the tablet, estimated each column at about or nity lines* cf. BE, XX. ip. 40, note 1;

‘THE SIGNIFICANCE OF “THE ACCOUNT

The new account of the creation and deluge is important from more than one point of view. First, it is written in Sumerian, while the other accounts, with the exception of three texts referring to the creation, exist in Semitic Babylonian only, and although we have seen that the Sumerian idiom of our text 1s no longer that of the classical period, yet the importance of our tablet is sufficiently established by the fact that it proves the existence of entirely independent larger Sumerian versions of the creation and deluge stories, and therefore may be regarded as an earnest of the discovery of considerably older Sumerian accounts.

However, even as it is, this Sumerian text reflects, at least In one point, theological conceptions which antedate by a considerable period most of those accounts with which we have been familiar. The older forms of religious belief in Babylonia can at the present time be inferred, on the whole, only from more or less occasional allusions in royal inscriptions, lists of gods, etc., and if therefore a new text enables us to verify one of these conclusions as here with regard to Enilil’s part in the creation, this must, of course, be very welcome. But more than this, our new text enables us to see the known parallel sources in several points in a new light, as, e. g., with regard to the position of one of the most important deities of the older Babylonian pantheon, the goddess Nin-harsag. Altogether new, however, is the information concerning the prediluvian cities and deities.

Furthermore, it has already been pointed out that our text, because it constitutes an independent version, is of considerable value for the tracing of different sources within the known deluge account in the Gilgame' epic. In this respect our new text has also an indirect bearing on the Biblical account of the deluge in Genesis 6,;—0,;, because the recognition of the composite character of the Babylonian versions gives us a valuable insight into that literary process by which the present composite Biblical account of the deluge must have been evolved.

II